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The praxeology of bypassing ocular-centric spatial relations

How visually impaired people use AI mobile object recognition when shopping

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Book of abstracts

THE VELUX FOUNDATIONS

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9.45-10.15	**Break**		
10.15-11.45	**Panel 1** *Sustainable consumption: Rhetorical and semiotic perspectives* Organizer: Anders Björkvall	**Panel 2** *Visualizing the virus: Visual research on digital practices in the age of Covid-19* Organizers: Rodney Jones & Elisabetta Adami	**Panel 3** *Do we need semiotics? Dialogues between Social Semiotics and EMCA* Organizer: Brian Due
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12.45-14.15	**Panel 4** *Digital (re)semiotization of buying/selling interaction* Organizers: Gitte Rasmussen, Elisabeth Dalby Kristiansen, Søren Vigild Poulsen & Morten Boeriis	**Panel 5** *What COVID-19 tells us about potentials, possibilities and pitfalls of digitalizing learning practices* Organizer: Nina Bonderup Dohn	**Panel 6** *Digital mediation: spaces, emergence, presence, issues, new phenomena, and methodology* Organizers: Anders Hougaard
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16.00-17.00	**Keynote 4** *Collaboration and interaction: Opportunities and challenges of interdisciplinary research in technological design and development* Paul Luff		

Keynote abstracts

FUNCTIONAL DESIGN AND IDENTITY DESIGN IN ONLINE SHOPPING SITES

Theo van Leeuwen, University of Denmark, Denmark

The pandemic has accelerated the speed with which a range of face to face interactions are moving online, and there is much discussion on the advantages and disadvantaged of this development, particularly in relation to learning and working from home.

Online practices must be fully and explicitly designed and are dis-embodied, taking the form of multimodal 'texts'. In this presentation, I discuss both these aspects, focusing on online shopping, but also referring to other online practices.

In discussing the design of online shopping sites, I build on a social semiotic tradition that goes back to Mitchell's study of North African markets (Mitchell, 1957), and includes studies of face to face shopping and other service encounters by Hasan (1985) and Ventola (1987), but I focus in particular on the process of recontextualization (Van Leeuwen, 2008), that is, on the way online shopping design transforms all the concrete aspects of face to face shopping - the participants, the interactions that constitute buying and selling, the styles in which these interactions are performed, the times and places where they occur, and the tools and materials they require.

In discussing the multimodality of online shopping design, I analyse the use of image and text in a range of shopping sites and in relation to a range of products, including groceries, fashion, books and technological products, with a focus on the functional design as well as the identity design (branding) of the sites.

I end by attempting to explain the move to online shopping on the basis of an analysis of its context - both the immediate, concrete context and the broader social, cultural and economic context.

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MATERIALITY, SENSORIALITY AND EMBODIMENT IN FACE-TO-FACE COMMERCIAL ENCOUNTERS

Lorenza Mondada, University of Basel, Switzerland

One fundamental aspect that co-present face-to-face shopping enables (vs. digital shopping) is a direct access to the materiality of the products as well as the possibility to engage in some talk with the seller in a situated way and in front of the product talked about. This paper addresses this specificity by taking materiality in interaction seriously: more specifically, it reflects about the relevance material qualities in specific activities and the way these material qualities are considered, accessed, experienced and talked about by the participants, in practices that involve a multisensorial engagement with the objects. This focus contributes to two distinct issues: firstly, the way in which a multimodal conversation analytic approach grounds an analysis of sensoriality; second, the way in which considering sensoriality, materiality and embodiment contributes to a better understanding of some activities, in particular economic activities.

The paper is based on a rich corpus of encounters in food shops and at the market, constituted by shop encounters that were video-recorded in Switzerland, and various European countries (and languages). The analysis shows how various senses are mobilized for selecting the products: vision is fundamental, also in encounters where other sensuous approaches are normatively forbidden (for hygienic, sanitary or safety reasons, including restrictions related to the Covid19 crisis), touch, smell and taste are locally mobilized, when permitted, to check, valuate, select the produces to buy. The analysis also discusses how these sensorial engagements are located within talk, which is some cases is the only way of accessing to the products – within the provision and negotiation of information between the seller and the customer. Accessing the materiality of objects, and more particularly the relevant material qualities of products for their selection and for the decision to buy them, is crucial for their assessment and 'valuation', as well as in relation to more general issues concerning the seller-client relationships, their mutual attention, mutual trust, and socio-interactional alignment.

THE HUMAN TOUCH OF DEPARTMENT STORES: ODE TO A LOST ICON, DAVID JONES

Louise Ravelli, University of New South Wales, Australia

The 'human touch' which characterises traditional shopping practices in physical stores can be both literal (e.g. feeling a fabric) and metaphorical (e.g. an ambience). This presentation provides a case study of one department store, 'David Jones' in Sydney, Australia, and the dramatic impact of the shift to online shopping on its retail success.

David Jones has been a long-term feature of the retail landscape in Australia, and has been such an icon of the culture that it is the subject of a novel, a musical, and a movie. It would be (more or less) comparable to other high-end department stores around the world. Its embodiment of glamour and service has come to define the store as an institution, characterising specific roles for both staff and customers, but the affordances of the conventional department store have been challenged in the current environment, disrupting a once-stable social practice.

Using Spatial Discourse Analysis (Ravelli and McMurtrie, 2016) and the concepts of discourse, design, production and distribution (Kress and van Leeuwen, 2001) the presentation compares the key attributes which defined David Jones in the past, how those attributes have been disrupted, how the store has responded to those disruptions, and why its responses seem less effective than those of some of its competitors.

Some of the description is anecdotal, using personal experience to demonstrate what the store stood for in the past (at least to compliant shoppers/users), while also arguing that multimodal approaches have an important contribution to make in revealing some of the reasons why conventional stores now struggle so much. Links are drawn with the related field of organization studies (see for example, Hoellerer et al, 2019). As Hoellerer et al say (2017: 6), the inter-relation of institutions and multimodality is fundamental, as institutions 'govern the use and effect of multimodal texts' but also are 'constituted multimodally'.

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COLLABORATION AND INTERACTION: OPPORTUNITIES AND CHALLENGES OF INTERDISCIPLINARY RESEARCH IN TECHNOLOGICAL DESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT

Paul Luff, King's Business School, England

In the 1980s it was uncommon for social scientists to be involved in technological research and development projects, Now it seems quite common for research teams

to involve them in some way, if only to help provide context, examples of the real world problems or to help assess prototype solutions. In this talk, I draw on over 30 years of working in collaborative research projects both with industrial and academic partners to discuss the challenges and opportunities made possible by this kind of interdisciplinary work. By discussing particular examples, I will endeavour to show that this collaboration can offer more than just social scientists evaluating a new prototype or providing information about the 'real world'. I will suggest that through interdisciplinary collaboration it can be possible to develop innovative methods for design and suggest different ways of conceiving of an innovation and its uses. These collaborations can also provoke more fundamental questions, not only for those developing the technology but also for the social scientists themselves.

Panel abstracts

PANEL 1: SUSTAINABLE CONSUMPTION: RHETORICAL AND SEMIOTIC PERSPECTIVES

Panel organizer: Anders Björkvall, Örebro University, Sweden
Discussant: Thomas Hestbæk Andersen, Director of the Danish Language Council, Denmark

Modern life comes with great challenges: the climate crisis, global health issues, and discrimination based on gender or race are just a few examples. Commercial actors have responded in different ways to such challenges, sometimes actually changing the way they do business in order to move their practices in a more sustainable direction. In other cases, their behavior remains more or less unchanged, but great effort is put into transforming the narratives around a company or a business field. In either case, the commercial replies to these challenges always involve elaborate communicative strategy work. In other words, these are highly semiotic practices that involve strategic meaning making. The arenas in which they take place are most commonly digital spaces such as social media, websites, apps and other online applications.
This panel brings together researchers from the media and communication, rhetoric and linguistics environments at Örebro University. All share an interest in semiotic, rhetorical and discursive aspects of production, consumption and marketing as meaning making. The panel presents research ranging from food and health discourses to air travel and the transition from store window mannequins of brick and mortar shopping to online shopping. As sustainability is intrinsically connected to different types of values and identities, the individual presentations and the panel as a whole revolves around ethical and emotional aspects of the commercial version of being a 'good' and 'sustainable' company, consumer, influencer and so on.

The research presented is theoretically and methodologically related to (multimodal) critical discourse studies along with visual and embodied rhetoric. The ambition with the discussion led by Hestbæk Andersen is to open up for alternative methodologies, theories and interpretations in our endeavor to develop a critical understanding of the communicative aspects of 'sustainable' production and consumption practices of modern life.

"THE PATH TO A LONG-TERM HEALTHY LIVING" – A MULTIMODAL CRITICAL DISCOURSE ANALYSIS OF THE SELT-CARE APP LIFESUM

Helen Andersson, Örebro University, Sweden

At a time when everyone is expected to take responsibility for but also optimize health (Petersen and Lupton, 1996) and pursue a 'healthy living' (Petersen et al., 2010), apps, 'self-tracking' and 'everyday analytics' become crucial. In this paper I examine the design of a self-care application, Lifesum, in relation to its socio-political context. More specifically, the purpose of the paper is to show how the design of the app not only shapes how practices that affect health, such as healthy eating, exercise and social engagement, are represented and communicated, but how the design itself reproduces and encourages certain ideas, values and actions that are highly valued in contemporary society. Previous research shows that apps and self-tracking devices contribute to self-monitoring and self-advocacy (Sanders, 2017; Doshi, 2018) and enable self-government and self-care (Whitson, 2015). However, not many studies critically examine the practices, ideas and values that the design of these apps promotes or facilitates.
The data consists of data from the Lifesum app. The study draws on the principles of multimodal critical discourse analysis (MCDA) (Machin and Mayr, 2012) using a discourse-design approach (Ledin and Machin, 2016). More particularly, I explore how practices that affect health are represented through writings, quantifications, spatialization, graphic shapes and icons, temporality and causality. I discuss how the design serves certain purposes and how it interacts with the user and encourages certain choices. The analysis shows that a sustainable "healthy life", as represented by the Lifesum app, should be understood in relation to values such as choice, individual freedom, personal responsibility, agency and consumer loyalty. Design is central to the process of shaping the user into a "good" and "healthy" citizen.

"HOW ARE YOU?" SHAME AND PRIDE IN THE DELEGITIMATION AND RELEGIMATION OF AIR TRAVEL IN THE PRE-COVID-19 ER

Anders Björkvall, Örebro University, Sweden
Gustav Westberg, Örebro University, Sweden

This paper delves into the unsettling of global air travel as a common-sense practice in the pre-Covid-19 era. Departing from social semiotics and multimodal critical discourse studies, the study sets out to systematically explore how flying is delegitimized via shaming practices by climate activists on Instagram, and how the aviation industry responds to such shaming practices by relegitimizing flying as a practice of pride. The dataset under investigation is two-folded and constitutes posts from the Swedish Instagram account Aningslösainfluencers ("Naïve Influencers") as

well as media texts produced for the Swedish market by the aviation industry. Here, we pay particular attention to a video-ad entitled "Now we take the next step for a positive tourism "("Nu tar vi nästa steg för positiv turism") published by Tui, where shame is explicitly responded to.
The analysis is guided by van Leeuwen's (2008) work on legitimation in combination with Ahmed's (2004) insights regarding the political potential of emotions. The results reveal that the delegitimation and relegitimating work of climate activists and the aviation industry depart from the same assumption that CO2 emissions are bad, and that they both use affect as a key component in their delegitimation and relegitimation strategy. However, whereas the climate activists perform their flight shaming by pointing to bad effects of the influencers' flying habits, the aviation industry is stuck with the bad effects of flying as a starting point for their relegitimation. Accordingly, reconstructing flight pride becomes their main objective.

SUSTAINING AUSTAINABLE CONSUMPTION? A MULTIMODAL CRITICAL DISCOURSE ANALYSIS OF FOOD PRODUCERS'/RETAILERS' CORPORATE STORIES

Göran Eriksson, Örebro University, Sweden

Through media and different forms of marketing we are repeatedly told that our food consumption could make a difference and slow down climate change, and thus be more sustainable. Food producers and retailers now offer products associated with moral and political choices, often through compelling language and communication design and in the name of the planet. It has been argued that such choices comprise a kind of 'moral consumerism', or 'consumer activism' (Banet-Weiser 2012), which, while possibly unclear concerning the actual consequences of the 'activism', allows shoppers to feel they are making good consumption choices and play the role of the conscious consumer–citizen (Johnston 2008). Like many other businesses today, these companies position themselves through creating specific corporate stories (Chen & Eriksson 2019). Such stories appear on the companies' websites. Using various semiotic materials such as language, visuals, symbols, colors, etc., these stories link symbolic ideas to companies and provide them with an identity supposed to distinguish them from other businesses. Employing the theory of social semiotics and using multimodal critical discourse analysis (MCDA) (Machin 2013; Ledin & Machin 2018; 2020), in this paper I engage in a critical examination of how such positioning is done. How do these companies design corporate stories to make themselves appear as good and planet-friendly businesses? How are stories designed to make their products appear as good and sustainable choices? The analysis focuses on tree corporate stories from companies selling and delivering food on the Swedish market: Alpro, a producer of plant-based drinks; Årstiderna ('The Seasons'), a company delivering recipe boxes; and Holistic, selling food supplements.

SHOPPING WINDIWS GO DIGITAL: THE CHANGE OF GENDER PERFORMANCE FROM URBAN CITY SHOPPING WINDIWS TO DIGITAL VERSIONS.

Marie Gelang, Örebro University, Sweden

In this paper the visual rhetoric of shop window displays will be examined with a special focus on store window mannequins' nonverbal expressions, such as postures (Matsumoto et al, 2013: 87-89) and proxemics (Hall, 1963; 1973). The data consist of over a thousand pictures of Swedish shopping window displays. Shop window displays reflect ideals, norms, values and desires that we embody to create our ethos and personae (i.e. those aspects of ourselves that we emphasize in a specific situation and our legitimation of them). I will argue that shop windows aim to persuade consumers to step into the store by means of the artistic design and visual rhetoric of mannequins: they embody the future consumer and establish a gendered ethos in the public. Inspired by visual rhetoric in general, and non-verbal methods in particular, the changing ethos and personae of store window mannequins' nonverbal expressions from the 1930s to the present day are decoded.

The paper will compare the results of the analysis to those of an ongoing project analysing the embodiment of gender when store window displays are transferred into online shopping sites. Focusing on the embodiment of gender in the web shop windows of the Swedish companies H&M, Hope, and KappAhl, the male and female mannequins' postures and proxemics will be analyzed. Accordingly, the analysis will provide answers to the following questions: Will the existing approach to gender in shopping window displays change when moving to internet shopping? And, what ethos and personae are performed in these silent rhetorical messages of gender?

PANEL 2: VISUALIZING THE VIRUS: VISUAL RESEARCH ON DIGITAL PRACTICES IN THE AGE OF COVID-19

Panel organizers:
Rodney Jones, University of Reading, United Kingdom
Elisabetta Adami, University of Leeds, United Kingdom

This panel focuses on how the Covid-19 pandemic has affected the way we conduct multimodal research in online environments. It examines how the pandemic has impacted visuality and visibility online, what sorts of research traditions and analytical tools can be drawn upon to address this impact, and what kinds of new tools need to be developed. The panel consists of four papers with a concluding discussion by the panel organizers. The papers illustrate four different strands of multimodal research: (1) the multimodal analysis of interaction (drawing on conversation analysis and interactional sociolinguistics), (2) social semiotic perspectives on multimodal meaning making, (3) explorations of multimodal intertextuality drawing on critical discourse analysis, and (4) multimodal meaning making as a tool for cultural positioning. They focus on a range of digital practices that have changed as a result of the pandemic, from video conferencing to video sharing to memeing, to children's online virtual play. All of the papers raise questions about the communicative landscape of the pandemic itself (how it has given rise to new forms of human communication and interaction and to broader social changes), the recent move towards the enhanced digitalization of social practices more generally, and the continued relevance of the 'visual turn' in discourse analytical research (which for a time seemed to have been superseded by a 'sensory' and 'material turn'). The concluding discussion will raise questions about the limitations of current methods and tools in multimodal research and explore ways the Covid-19 crisis has created opportunities to push theoretical and methodological integration further and to develop innovative approaches to the study of digital communication.

"I SEE YOU'RE TREATING YOURSELF WELL". VISUALIZING AND VIEWING PRIVATE SPACES IN VIDEO-MEDIATED INTERACTIONS: EPISTEMIC AND DEONTIC TRUTH IN/OF THE GAZE

Maria Grazia Sindoni, University of Messina, Italy

Video mediated interactions have recently garnered academic and popular attention since the covid-19 pandemic hit. Zoom, FaceTime, Houseparty, Microsoft Teams, and other video apps, have become fully ingrained in daily interactions for mundane, educational and work purposes during lockdown times, to the point of becoming essential tools to maintain acceptable levels of sociality – and the possibility to keep up with the "new normal" (Ammar 2020).

Previous studies have amply documented some of the medium-specific affordances of video-calls, such as media space and communicative asymmetries (Heath and Luff 1992), problematic use of gaze (Vertegaal and Ding 2002), specific alternations of spoken and written language (Sindoni 2013), change of settings and background in video-base mobile calls (Licoppe and Morel 2014), participatory engagements and cross-modal exchanges (Rosenbaum et al. 2016). However, the so-called Zoom boom (Ammar 2020) calls for, and indicates, further lines of investigation that this presentation intends to address.

My study is motivated by a research question that has become all the more cogent in the first half of 2020, broadly dealing with the exploration of discourse practices and ideological implications of the abrupt transition of most activities from face-to-face to online. The pressing need to convert all social life (including educational and work activities) to online has forced millions of users worldwide to use video communication at an unprecedented pace (for ex. Zoom was used by c. 10 million users by December 2019, but reportedly reached 200 million daily users by early March 2020, Yuan 2020). Two interlaced facets of gaze will be dealt with, namely visualising (acts of making something visible to the eye by video mediation) and viewing (acts of intentional looking, referred to perceptual cognition).

These different forms of gaze will be presented by addressing the following research questions:

1. Assuming that a significant number of public and private institutions worldwide switched from offline to online, and that these activities required a proportional amount of online video interaction (mostly carried out at home and not from office, as was usual practice), how has this drastic and unilateral decision affected discourse practices, communities and ideologies?

2. How has the sudden intrusion of an unmonitored, external and pervasive gaze (Jones 2020) had an impact on conversational practices, with a view to if and how these have been re-constructed, re-adapted and/or resisted in a range of dynamics, for example in private vs. public space and in personal vs. work/educational settings?

For heuristic purposes, I will present examples of deontic visual/viewing modality (i.e. expressing how the world ought to be according to certain ideas and expectations), and of epistemic visual/viewing modality (i.e. expressing how the world is perceived to be according to knowledge or beliefs). Deontic and epistemic visual modality can be encoded in visualising and viewing oneself, the other/s and the external world, perceived by participants as being discursively framed onscreen.

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#PLAYAPARTTOGETHER: CHILDREN'S DIGITAL MEDIA PLAY DURING THE COVIS-19 PANDEMIC

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From the early stages of the COVID-19 outbreak onwards, reports emerged of children incorporating references to the pandemic in all forms of play, adapting and modifying existing games and creating new ones. This included digital and media play, for example, in the creation of coronavirus clinics in Minecraft and the emergence of new online games such as Corona Wash and Vax (Kobu, 2020). Digital play took on particular significance as closures of schools and playgrounds restricted spaces for play and limited physical contact with friends. In response, gaming companies promoted the World Health Organisation campaign '#Playaparttogether' to support social distancing through video games, and families shared examples of children playing with distant family and friends via video calls and in-game chat.
This paper will draw on sociocultural theories of childhood (James & Prout, 1997) and multimodal social semiotic perspectives (Kress, 1997) to examine examples of digital play gathered in 2020 since the outbreak of the pandemic, under lockdown, and during ongoing social distancing. Viewing play as multimodal meaning-making (Potter & Cowan, 2020) highlights ways in which children use combinations of modes such as image, sound, layout and movement to communicate their thoughts, feelings and understandings of the COVID-19 pandemic through play. The findings underline

the important role played by digital technologies and media cultures, as well as the 'hybrid' forms of physical-digital play in which children increasingly engage.
The findings offer insights into children's experiences of the pandemic, beyond those which may be easily articulated in language. Since the pandemic impacted where, when, how and with whom children could play, the affordances of digital technologies are identified as particularly significant for enabling socially-distanced play, offering new play possibilities and giving insights into play's resilience and adaptability.

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MEMIFIED TENSIONS IN SOCIETY DURING A PANDEMIC: INTERTEXTUALITY IN COVID-19 INTERNET MEMES

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Creating an unprecedented global public health risk, the Covid-19 pandemic has impacted our social, institutional, professional and everyday practices, including our diverse, affective, and collective responses to it on digital media platforms in a time of great uncertainty. Along with the increasing generation and sharing or multimodal content online, internet memes, as "groups of multimodal cultural artifacts that usually share features of content, form, or stance and that are created, modified, and spread across the web with awareness of each other" (Shifman, 2014), have become a popular digital genre by which ordinary people interpret, express, reproduce and propagate various ideas and meanings that derive from viral media events (Milner, 2013; Shifman, 2014). While many internet memes are humorous, such as LOLcats (Miltner, 2014) and advice animals (Dynel, 2016), others are politically-oriented and provoke a shift in collective discourse through the expression of public opinions and political activism (Bayerl and Stoynov, 2016). A prominent feature of internet memes is that they are intertextual, drawing on past, present, or future actions and discourses (Al Zidjaly, 2017).

In this paper, I examine a set of Covid-19 internet memes collected between 12 March 2020 and August 2020 to explore the intertextual connections between Covid-19 and

the existing social issues, tensions, and inequalities in the society. The data come from social media platforms, particularly Facebook, where I identified the frequently shared memes that make reference to wider social issues via Covid-19. I also searched for news stories and blog posts related to Covid-19 and memes. Through an iterative and inductive process, I identified the emerging themes and coded the memes individually. Among the emergent themes are environment, education, domestic abuse, income inequality, and healthcare. While some memes have direct references to Covid-19 at the textual level, some make only implicit references to Covid-19 requiring advanced inferential strategies and shared and collective awareness of social issues. The findings indicate that while internet memes are "small expressions", they have "big implications" (Milner, 2016), helping ordinary people make connections between feelings, positions, and values and such creative participatory discourses shed light on social structures, inequalities, and power dynamics.

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FACE MASKS ON YOUTUBE: A MULTIMODAL APPROACH

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This presentation explores how face masks have been represented on YouTube as a way to make certain cultural positioning and stereotypes visible and pronounced. Wearing a face mask or not has been interpreted by some as evidence of 'cultural' differences between East Asians and Europeans/Americans, and by some others as a

sign of (un)preparedness, and how socially responsible one is. Eventually this is morphed into assigning people into categories of 'right' and 'wrong'. Whilst it is evident that the discourses around face masks have been changing throughout the duration of the pandemic, this presentation focuses on one point in time, featuring one online video uploaded by a learner of Chinese at the early stage of the pandemic, and explores how the aforementioned positioning is constructed multimodally through the creative deployment of semiotic resources. With the use of an integrated analytical framework informed by social semiotic multimodality (Kress, 2010) and translanguaging (Li Wei, 2011, 2018), this presentation unpacks how the video-creator positions himself as prepared and socially responsible by showing alignment with the face mask culture, and with cultures that embrace mask-wearing practices both linguistically and semiotically. Through conducting multimodal analysis on the video, it was found that at different points of the video, the video-creator occupies multiple positions to highlight certain aspects of his identity, and his shifts between multiple positions and stances are also made known to the audience through an orchestration of multimodal and multilingual resources that he possesses. This integrated framework offers a socio-historical and cultural dimension to our understanding of multimodal and multilingual practices. Overall, the presentation aims to contribute to a methodological understanding of how positioning is created through the orchestration of a range of resources available to the social actor in a digitally mediated context.

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DISCUSSION: THE FUTRUE OF VISUAL RESEARCH IN DIGITAL ENVIRONMENTS IN TIMES OF DISRUPTION

Elisabetta Adami, University of Leeds, United Kingdom
Rodney Jones, University of Reading, United Kingdom

The concluding discussion, facilitated by the organizers, will include all members of the panel, who will explore the affordances and constraints of the different approaches illustrated in the four papers in light of the dramatic changes in the norms and conduct online and offline social interaction as a result of the pandemic. They will also explore ways the Covid-19 crisis has created opportunities for them to push

theoretical and methodological integration further and to develop innovative approaches to the study of social interactions, such as the PanMeMic project pioneered by Adami et al. (2020). Finally, they will discuss a range of ethical questions about visibility that have arisen out of the crisis, including (1) the increased visibility of some social actors through the unsettling of boundaries between public and private brought about through the increased digitization of everyday social practices, as well as the ways the pandemic has been used to justify the increased surveillance of citizens by governments, and (2) the increased invisibility of other social actors whose practices fall outside of the structures for digitally mediated-interaction that have become so central during the pandemic, and the new forms of marginalization that have resulted.

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PANEL 3: DO WE NEED SEMIOTICS? DIALOGUES BETWEEN SOCIAL SEMIOTICS AND EMCA

Panel organizer: Brian Due, University of Copenhagen, Denmark

While the majority of research in multimodality often departs from a semiotic framework (Kress, 2009) exploring objects, people and signs in the world by providing understandings of the semiotic resources, the tradition of multimodal ethnomethodological conversation analysis (EMCA) (Mondada, 2014) has mostly resisted using a 'full-blown' semiotic framework. The argument is typically, that semiotic theorizing reduces the empirical phenomena to semiotic terminology and thus, rather than providing new knowledge, just theoretically re-describe the world in structural or cognitive terms. On the contrary, EMCA has been criticized for at times being empiricist and not engaging enough with theory. In this panel, we will discuss the usage of and problems with different semiotic frameworks in a pursuit of bridging and/or highlighting differences between a social semiotic and an EMCA approach to multimodality, and also touch upon the semiotic tensions within each branch of research traditions. Each presentation will not "just" be a theoretical discussion but also be based on empirical examples to support the argument. The panel consist of three presentations that is organized so that the first emphasize the overall differences between semiotics in EMCA and in Social Semiotics by taking an EMCA stand, the second by taking a Social Semiotics stand and the last by providing an account for, how EMCA could expand its notion of member to include other forms of agency.

ON SEEKING TO CONNECT TWO KINDS OF ANALYSIS

Eric Laurier, School of GeoSciences, Scotland

In this talk I will contrast the approaches to ordinary practices of ethnomethodology and semiotics. Both approaches share an attentiveness to the details of the world. Semiotics provides careful descriptions of images, texts, new media, architecture and more. Yet semiotics retains the role of the scholar as the analyst that recovers the intelligibility and operation of the meaning and reference of signs in the broadest sense. Its accomplishments are in the analysts' work. EM's desire is to reveal the accomplishments of members and their in-vivo analyses. Members' ordinary practices may then indeed use semiotic resources, amongst other resources (the best known perhaps being the turn-taking device in organising talk). EM's constant reminder is that the intelligibility of images, texts, new media etc. are members' accomplishment. I will revisit McHoul's (1996) "Effective semiotics" and the lessons we can learn from it in integrating semiotics with ethnomethodology and hints of at least one abiding problem for ethnomethodological studies.

SAPTIAL STRUCTURE AS CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK FOR NAVIGATING AND INTERACTING IN A SHOP: IN THE CROSS FIELD OF EYE-TRACING, MEMBER'S KNOWLEDGE AND ARMCHAIR SEMIOTICS

Morten Boeriis, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

In this presentation it is discussed how working as a social semiotician entail a great deal of observatory sensitivity and how the concrete observations and analysis may reflect on both descriptive categories and theoretical axioms as the functional and descriptive approach is committed to describe conventions in actual social practices (Kress 2010, Kress & van Leeuwen 2001).
This presentation combines the perspectives from the social semiotic metafunctions (Halliday & Matthiessen 2004, Kress & van Leeuwen 2006) with eye-tracking recordings of actual shopping situations to uncover the relation between the designed structures and the actual actions of customers in the shops (cf. Ravelli & McMurtrie 2016). The talk is based on a larger scale eye-tracking study of shopping situations in both online-shop and physical-shop environments consisting of in total 1040 minutes of eye-tracking recordings of 64 individual shopping situations.
The multimodal social semiotic framework makes it possible to uncover in the eye-tracking data how both online and 'offline' shoppers shift between specific alternating structural perspectives and appertaining strategies in order to navigate the semiotic shopping environment according to their interest (Boeriis & Holsanova 2012; Boeriis 2012), which both cause considerations about the adequacy of description of the textual structures in social semiotics and about how the multimodal relation between the design and use of structures can be seen as interaction between shop owners and customers.

SEMIOTICS OF DISTRIBUTED PERCEPTION: WHOSE AGENCY?

Brian Due, University of Copenhagen, Denmark

This paper introduces a framework based on EMCA and semiotics related to practices concerned with perception. This is subsumed under the title: semiotics of distributed perception. It will be argued in this presentation, that perception is not just a private, cognitive experience based on one's own motor skills and interpretation of sensory input, but achieved in and through practical communicative actions in co-operation with other agents. Based on years of video ethnographic research conducted among visually impaired people and an EMCA and semiotic framework, this paper introduces the concept of perception-related actions and shows how these are observably provided by other agents as resources that constitutes a distributed perceptual field, which enables blind people to perceive and construct actions.

The kind of semiotics that will be brought into the EMCA framework is the triadic Peircean (1955) tradition with a reference to the works of Kockelman (2005), Enfield (2017) and Goodwin ; i.e. with a focus on the interactional accountability of the sign production. In this presentation I will particular focus on different forms of semiotic agency. One reason EMCA scholars arguably could to turn to semiotics is in order to get a more vivid terminology and understanding of the agents involved in interactions. EMCA do not recognize ANT's heterogenous approach to agents but maintains the ability of accountability. Not in any juridical sense, but in the ethnomethodological understanding of member's procedures for making settings accountable and in some way to hold agents responsible.

To make actions accountable involves also producing them in ways that make them recognizable for what they are (Koschmann, 2012). Other agents than human beings may produce accountable actions as we clearly dismiss cognition as relevant. In this presentation I will show how distributed perception is achieved in and through actions and assistance from a human agent, a non-human (dog) agent and a technological AI agent. Although a dog and an AI hardly can be said to have "commonsense knowledge" (Garfinkel & Sacks, 1986, p. 178) as members of a society, they can surely act in ways "that are sensible in that society and in the situations in which they find themselves" (Have, 2002, p. 6).

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PANEL 4: DIGITAL (RE)SEMIOTIZATION OF BYING/SELLING INTERACTION

Panel organizers:
Gitte Rasmussen, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark
Elisabeth Dalby Kristiansen, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark
Søren Vigild Poulsen, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark
Morten Boeriis, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

E-shopping is growing and increasingly affects all of us. It transforms the shopping streets in villages and towns as more and more brick-and mortar shops close down and changes the way customers and retailers interact, the way goods and services can be displayed, the way goods can be examined, and the perceived and real risks customers as well as retailers are exposed to. What is in face-to-face shopping an embodied and situated interaction in and through which goods can be physically displayed, touched and handled, is in e-shopping turned into a two-dimensional world in which goods are presented, inspected and selected by means of words and images, which requires technical, linguistic and visual literacies not everyone has access to.

This panel aims at comparing e- and face-to-face shopping by describing the semiotic resources that are at play in the two settings and how these are used and organized in the different environments. Furthermore, it seeks to discuss the relevance of categorizing digital shopping practices in terms of resemiotization of practices in brick-and mortar shops.

The panel brings together research in EMCA multimodal interaction (Hazel, Mortensen, & Rasmussen, 2014; Mondada, 2016) and social semiotic multimodality (Kress & Van Leeuwen, 2001; Van Leeuwen, 2015). Researchers from both analytic frameworks approach the topic of the panel from their respective analytic frameworks in dialogue with one another. They focus on empirical data as they draw upon data that was collected as part of the research project 'The digital (re)semiotization of buying and selling interaction" (RESEMINA) which is funded by the VELUX foundations and based at the University of Southern Denmark. . The data consists of video recordings of shopping activities in different types of stores and of eye-tracker recordings of their eye movements and fixations.

The panel also entails a data session in which video- and eyetracker- recordings are presented, analyzed and discussed.

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DOING A SEARCH FOR (E-)SHOPPING PURPOSES – ON HOW ACTIONS ARE FITTED TO THE (E-)ENVIRONMENTS AND STRUCTURES

Gitte Rasmussen, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark
Elisabeth Dalby Kristiansen, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

Digital technologies provide possibilities for conducting everyday affairs and people seem to continuously allow them to (re)shape the way they do ordinary activities, including shopping.
Shopping entails a variety of actions and activities, e.g. searching, reading shopping lists, talking to family members, engaging staff, examining goods, queueing. This paper focuses specifically on searching. It describes how customers systematically order search actions multimodally (Kress, 2010) in recognizable ways (Garfinkel 2002) and (re)establish practices for doing so. It describes how customers e.g. gaze in the direction of specific areas and products, move bodily in specific directions, touch products in specific ways, design talk to specific recipients at specific points in time, or write specific keywords and click on specific representations of images for the purpose of purchasing products online. In other words it demonstrates how they, routinely and competently, employ and coordinate different modes and media as they gear the details of their actions to the different environments and structures in which their search emerges incrementally (Mondada, 2016).
While customers take searching for granted in both digital and physical shopping environments, they rely on designs and structures of (displays and/or representations of) goods and paths that are provided to them by others. Whereas the customers in brick and mortar shops may witness e.g. how they come to navigate between aisles, e-shoppers may not have access to that kind of knowledge. On this basis the paper is closed by discussing the notion of competence in both environments.

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THE DESIGN AND USE OF INFORMATION VALUE: THE CASE OF ELECTRONICS SHOPPING

Morten Boeriis, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark
Søren Vigild Poulsen, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

In this paper, we will revisit the concept of information value (Kress & van Leeuwen, 2006), i.e., the values assigned to elements based on their placement in a text composition, to explore how the same basic information about products is structured and functions in offline and online shopping settings.
Empirical data from our research project on digital resemiotization of shopping practices suggests that if we look at how information about products is organized in a physical store, and if we compare it to the product presentation in the associated webshop, we find the approximately same information is shown quite differently in offline and online settings. It may follow that these two environments invite distinct interactivities (Adami, 2014) with and interpretations of the same products.
To elaborate on these discoveries, we combine methods from multimodal social semiotics (Boeriis, 2015; Ravelli & McMurrie, 2016), cognitive eyetracking studies (Holsanova, Rahm & Holmqvist, 2006), and geosemiotics (Scollon & Scollon, 2003). This analytical framework enables us to make detailed descriptions of the design of production information structures in the store and on the website, respectively, as well as the shopping practices where people use these information structures. The dataset consists of video and eyetracking recordings from an electronics store and website.
The paper presents new findings on how different tensions are created between the organization of information and how people actually interact with and evaluate information in offline and online contexts.

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PANEL 5: WHAT COVID-19 TELLS US ABOUT PTENTIALS, POSSIBILITIES AND PITFALLS OF DIGITALIZING LEARNING PRACTICES

Panel organizer: Nina Bonderup Dohn, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

All around the world, COVID-19 has sent learners, teachers, conference delegates, seminar organizers, workshop participants etc. home for a prolonged period of time, the extent of which was known to no one on beforehand. Formal and informal learning practices accordingly became digitalized from one day to the next, irrespective of the sentiments and beliefs of the participants as regards the viability of online and ICT-mediated learning. The creativity of many in trying out and inventing new formats for engaging learners has been notable. Sometimes organizers and participants alike have been surprised at their resulting experiences of new opportunities for openness, democratic communication and effectiveness of learning. However, frustration has equally been a recurring experience, especially as regards the limits which lack of physical presence sets academically and socially, both quite generally and in terms of specific learning practices based on physical co-location. As we proceed into the third semester of non-voluntary online learning practices, the spirit of inventiveness may be receding somewhat to a feeling of fatigue with the "new normal" and a feeling of loss as regards social interaction. But, also, we see new online and hybrid formats for learning emerging as another kind of "new normal" that might continue their existence in post-COVID-19 learning.
In this panel, four learning and education researchers will explore and discuss what COVID-19 can tell us theoretically and practically about the potentials, possibilities and pitfalls of digitalizing learning practices. The work of all four researchers have for more than a decade focused (in different ways) on the significance of materiality and space (physical, virtual and/or hybrid) for participation and learning. They will each highlight points from their pre-COVID-19 research on these subjects which serves to interpret the positive and negative experiences of learners during COVID-19. Likewise, they will reflect on the new insights which teaching and learning practices during COVID-19 has brought to their previous research.

OPEN ONLINE LEARNING FORMATS IN A CLOSED WORLD? NEW WAYS OF ENGAGING THE WORLD AND CONNECTING WITH EACH OTHER DURING THE PANDEMIC

Rikke Toft Nørgård, Aarhus University, Denmark

Hybrid education works intentionally with the dissolution of dichotomies in learning such as online-onsite, open-closed, formal-nonformal, institution-society, teacher-student, individual-group or personal-professional in order to create new breeds of formats for learning. During the COVID-19 lockdown there has been a spike in

searches for and usage of hybrid education and hybrid learning as education worldwide has been forced online. Institutions have been faced with the challenge of creating new online and hybrid forms of teaching and learning. Even though hybrid education and learning as a field has existed for decades, it has become prominent during COVID-19 with its dissolution of places (participating in the online classroom from one's home), dissolution of roles (simultaneously being a parent/partner/roommate/pet owner and a student/teacher), dissolution of types (socializing through 'formal' technologies such as Zoom or learning through 'informal' technologies such as Slack or Messenger) and dissolution of encapsulation (learning in the open, in cafes or in webinars open to the public). These new hybrid formats carry with them new possibilities and potentials for learning both during the pandemic and in a post-COVID-19 world. However, there has also been pitfalls of isolation, poor learning formats and lack of competences when it comes to both technological set-ups, online learning activities and hybrid pedagogy.
The presentation draws on research into hybrid education, pedagogy and learning as well as actual practice of hybrid education during COVID-19 in order to present and discuss some of the new open online learning formats that have emerged during the pandemic lockdown. Through the discussion of one such new hybrid format for learning, I shall argue for how such formats – with the proper set-up, pedagogy and learning design – might foster new ways for learners to connect with each other and engage education and the world – also in a post-COVID-19 world.

ACADEMIC CONFERENCES IN A COVID ERA. NEW WAYS OF CONDUCTING AND ATTENDING ACADEMIC CONFERENCES

Jens Jørgen Hansen, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

The Covid-19 lockdown has challenged many of the ways in which institutions have handled and organised pedagogical tasks. One of these tasks is organising academic conferences. This presentation will discuss how online conferences create new opportunities for conference settings, forms of participation and forms of connection and communication in online conferences. The opportunities are due to both the technological development of digital platforms (as Zoom, Microsoft Teams, Google Meet etc.) that allows massive online participation and the development of digital back channel features such as Twitter and chat functions on digital platforms. These digital back channels enable the expansion of communication and participation for conference participants. I will argue that academic conference can be categorized in three different formats:

1) The traditional conference (transmission format) with physical presence with presenter and audience.

2) The hybrid conference (twitter format) with physical and formal presence of the presenter and with informal questions, discussion and comments through twitter as a

back channel. This format changes the dynamics of the format from one-to-many transmission to many-to-many interaction.

3) Online conferences (chat format) with online participants through a digital platform. In the last format, the communication is recognized by taking place in the common room, both trough formal oral communication and informal chat communication.

This presentation will discuss the potentials of the online conference format:

- Opportunity to ask questions and answers during the presentation
- Participants' contribution with information, resources and references that augment the topic in useful ways
- Supporting active participation of the participants in the conference
- Opportunity of knowledge sharing and knowledge collection for all participants

Finally, I will discuss which didactic implications online conferences have.

The presentation draws on research in conference formats and the use of digital back channels.

COVID-19 AND THE DIGITALIZATION OF HIGHER EDUCATION- RESOURCEFULNESS AND TEACHERS' PRACTICAL THINKING

Bente Meyer, Aalborg University, Denmark

Lockdowns and transformations of teaching into online formats have challenged teaching and learning in higher education in the Spring and Autumn, of 2020. For teachers, reorganizations of pedagogy into digital formats have to some extent been an emergency measure to ensure continuity and quality in teaching. Thus, teachers have drawn on their professional knowledge and experience, but have also learned from provisional designs, improvisations, observations and developments of practice. The question is therefore how we can identify ways in which teachers learn from engaging in online teaching practices and how this can become a resource in developing the digitalization of learning in higher education.

In discussing these issues I am proposing that we focus on teachers' practical thinking as an aspect of their engagement in practice. I use the concept bricolage to understand ways in which practical thinking operates as a form of tinkering and situated problem solving in teaching. Bricolage originates from Lévi-Strauss' The Savage Mind (1966), and has been used in research on eg technology in education (Sørensen 2009, Kress 2010, Turkle & Papert 1990). In The Savage Mind, Lévi-Strauss develops the idea of bricolage by contrasting the approaches of the bricoleur with that of the engineer. The purpose of this argument is to identify aspects of what Lévi-Strauss calls the science of the concrete, a kind of practical thinking that he associates with the bricoleur. The engineer is thus a builder who engages in the world through conceptual and abstract thinking. In comparison, the bricoleur is a tinkerer, who uses

whatever tools he has in his treasury to solve the task at hand. As a tinkerer, the bricoleur performs within the constraints of availability and proximity, and therefore reorganizes and reappropriates his inventory for use rather than (re)conceptualizes it. In this sense the bricoleur is resourceful but also grounded, as his heterogeneous treasury of available tools define his approach to building and problem solving, rather than the intellectual abstractions of the engineer. Therefore, his means may seem limited, but technically his resourcefulness is sophisticated and rich. Following this, bricolage can be understood in the context of teaching both as a creativity that crafts solutions 'out of nothing' (Baker & Nelson 2005), and as an ad-hocism with a conservative approach to production and problem solving (Hatton 1988). I shall discuss these different interpretations of teachers' practical thinking and relate them to the practice of teaching in digitalized classrooms in and after the Covid-19 lockdown.

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DESIGN FOR LEARNING IN THE LIGHT OF COVID-19 – PEDAGOGICAL CHALLENGES AND POSSIBILITIES IN DIGITALIZING LEARNING PRACTICES

Nina Bonderup Dohn, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

Design for learning is concerned with the organization of learning possibilities for others, taking into account the who, what, where, when, why and how of learning. The COVID-19 lockdown radically and involuntarily changed the "where" of the learning practices. In the experience of teachers and learners, the result was a need to rethink the "how" which, in turn, raised questions about the "who" and the "when": Should the physical presence situation be replicated as much as possible in synchronous online sessions on Zoom, Microsoft Teams or the like, with the teacher speaking from a shared screen of PowerPoint slides, complemented with slots of students solving tasks in breakout rooms? Or should the online format take advantage of the flexibility which the removal of the requirement for co-location opens up, e.g. for asynchronous discussion of syllabus texts, with students in leading and moderating roles and the teacher as facilitator on the side? Could the change to an online "where" allow students to draw more easily on material from other contexts as well (thus leading to changes in the "what")? Might this in the end lead to challenging the aim of the session (the "why"), e.g. with a shift in focus from students developing knowledge about specific content to an aim about participating in content creation across settings? Drawing on two decades of research within the field of networked learning, I shall argue for ways in which physical and virtual learning spaces can complement each other, in particular if focus is on what I term the primary contexts of the students. I shall also discuss the apparent discrepancy between the results of this research - which does not favor the attempt at copying the physical learning situation in a synchronous

online format - and student experiences during COVID-19, which to some extent do appear to favor this format.

PANEL 6: DIGITAL MEDIATION: SPACES, EMERGENCE, PRESENCE, ISSUES, NEW PHENOMENA, AND METHODOLOGY

Panel organizer: Anders Hougaard, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

On a massive and unprecedented scale the COVID-19 pandemic has taken people away from their usual, embodied, everyday social activities and replaced them with digital substitutes. In all corners of everyday life effort has been put into moving professional, institutional and leisure time activities onto a broad range of online platforms. This crisis situation can thus be seen a major media-evolutionary transition point which has made technological mediation a main practical concern in people's everyday lives. The popular technologies of the COVID-19 period were already used heavily and widely before the pandemic. However, their sudden drastically enhanced salience in our lives and the reception both popularly and academically of increased mediatization calls for more focus on the very phenomena of mediation and technology-world relations. Both public discourse and much academic parlance tends to view social activities in and around digital technology in terms of simple distinctions and dichotomies, including digital vs embodied, real vs virtual, "on" vs "off", and the notion of media as something that stands "between" and simply allows partial transfers "between" physical spaces.

However, with the tradition of medium theory, the growing enterprise of "post-phenomenology" and recent trends of embodiment theoretical, conversation analytic, ethnographic and phenomenological studies a rich, multidisciplinary and multimethodological basis exists for addressing in qualitative detail that lived and practiced field of daily mediations which appears to be under constant development with the introduction of new and updated technologies and the emergence of practices, experiences, possibilities and problems that follow in their wake.

This panel poses the activity and experience of (doing, accomplishing, experiencing) mediation as a general and still relatively under-studied phenomenon in its own right. We are deeply indebted to and stand on the shoulders of earlier, insightful research, but we call for a deeper and broader, consistent and coherent wave of research which zooms in on contemporary technology users' everyday mediation.

CHILDREN'S DIGITALLY MEDIATED PLAY PRACTICES IN EARLY CHILDHOOD EDUCATION AND CARE: A CULTURAL-HISTORICAL PERSPECTIVE

Jan Ole Størup, Aarhus University, Denmark

In recent years, digital media have become ubiquitous in the everyday lives of young children. In Denmark, the consequences of "screen time" and digital media have been common topics of worry in public discourse, especially in regards to the psychological, physical and social development and well-being of children, also

encompassing concerns related to the transformation of children's play. Parallelly, the pedagogical and educational benefits of new digital technologies on the one hand and play on the other have been emphasized in a new national pedagogical curriculum ("Den styrkede pædagogiske læreplan") in early childhood education and care (ECEC), underlining play as valuable in itself and inciting the implementation of digital devices in educational activities.
This paper explores the nature of digitally mediated play practices of young children in Danish ECEC settings. Departing from a cultural-historical perspective, the paper draws upon the concepts of activity settings and flickering to understand the socially motivated digital play and participatory practices of children. The theoretical concepts included illuminate empirical excerpts from qualitative inquiries of a large-scale mixed-methods study on the use of digital media in Danish ECECs conducted in early 2020. Specifically, data from participant observations in three Danish kindergartens illustrate how children's digital play practices are characterized by an array of various participant positions as well as a dialectical interplay between collective-individual and digital-analogue motives within activity settings.
Results are discussed in relation to dominant public discourses surrounding children's digital play practices and "screen time" as e.g. passive and isolated activities, and views of digital and analogue play as dichotomous concepts are challenged. Instead, children's mediated play practices are argued to blur the digital-analogue divide by actively incorporating analogue motives into digital play practices and vice versa.

BETWEEN THE SCREENS - NEW (IM)POSSIBILITIES IN THE DIGITALLY MEDIATED EXCHANGE OF MEANINGS

Jesper Tække, Aarhus University, Denmark

After a half year of homework because of COVID-19 many of us have not only experiences with conferences, meetings, teaching and private conversations on media like Zoom and Teams, we are beginning to get used to the situations and find them more natural. It's not like we do not miss the physical presence, or are not annoyed with the technology´s shortcomings, but that we also begin to feel relaxed and have better aligned expectations to the digitally mediated meetings. Also, different practices begin to develop that correspond with the possibilities of the new situations enabled by the distance and the technology that mediate the interactions and presentations.
In this paper I will put forward some (post)phenomenological examples of the new situation and discuss them to try to find out about their potential in relation to the physical isolation communication situation of the COVID-19 lockdown. The empirical phenomenological examples I will take from two international conferences, my teaching and administrative meetings from my own department. Theoretically I will draw on systems theory and medium theory.

INTERVIEWS WITH CHILDREN IN TIMES OF PHYSICAL DISTANCE: EXPLORING AFFORDANCES OF VIDEO CONFERENCE SOFTWARE

Stine Liv Johansen, Aarhus University, Denmark
Thomas Enemark Lundtofte, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

Due to the global outbreak of COVID-19 at the beginning of 2020, schools, kindergartens and day-cares in Denmark were closed down in mid-March, and since reopened under a set of restrictions put in place to hinder contagion. At their core, these restrictions were about hygiene and physical distance, the latter of which resulted in limited options for research interviews and observations with children. As researchers of children's media practices, we are used to visiting children in their private homes in order to conduct interviews and observe situated practices. In order to collect valuable data under the aforementioned circumstances, we decided to explore video conference software (e.g. Skype, Zoom, Google Meet) as research tools for conducting interviews with children aged 3-12 years (n=20). Initially, we were unsure whether this method would work – especially with the younger age group – since these types of mediated conversations involve complex media practices. However, the children had become rather familiar with these technologies, as had parents, presumably also due to the work-from-home situation in a number of families. video-mediated method. Additionally, video-mediation provided us with access to children's private settings and allowed them and us to show each other objects, including digital artefacts via screen-sharing functions. While video-mediation can be a useful tool for interviewing children, it comes with a set of challenges as well, which we will discuss in order to work towards methodological development.

MANAGING ENGAGEMENT IN THE SOCIAL SPACE OF ONLINE GAMING

Elisabeth Muth Andersen, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark
Anders Hougaard, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

In the last decade both academic and public debate around children's digital life has often entertained gloomy assumptions and theories about alleged socially deteriorating effects of being connected via media rather than in the flesh. Alarmist news stories have reported that children lose social skills and the ability to communicate due to always being on digital media. According to one of the most famous critics of the role of digital media in children's lives in recent years Sherry Turkle (2015) the "screen" most notably presents a way of hiding from each other and avoiding conversation. However, the impression one may form from news stories and much of the academic work and research that has been quoted in the media in recent years is challenged by what may be found in interactional studies of naturally-occurring gaming.

Online multiplayer games not only involve interaction between individual players and the in-game actions and universe, crucially it also involves social interaction between players. Games such as the survival game Fortnite allow for players to organize as teams and to communicate verbally with team members using Voice over IP-systems such as Discord during games. This paper analyzes how interactional resources are distributed between and utilized by the participants in a two-player-team mission in Fortnite.

Focusing on instances in which one of the participants' avatar 'dies', we analyze how the participants continue their common mission by distributing their resources such that one participant mainly participates by 'interacting with the game', whereas the other participant actively indicates his understanding of and teammate-involvement in the in-game actions through verbal actions.

We show how, after having accounted for 'dying' (Rusk & Ståhl, 2020) topicalising previous actions, the 'dead' participant re-engages in the joint mission by recognizably making noticings of and response cries (Goffman, 1978) to actions happening in the game, thereby positioning himself as an active spectator and teammate. In several instances, he comments on the in-game actions done by his teammate in evaluative terms, thereby displaying no accountability for the actions while continuing displaying active spectatorship.

We also show how he uses singing and other 'performative resources' (Aarsand & Aronsson, 2009) such as using English expressions with a distinct accent to indicate his continued social presence in the setting of the game and an understanding of the current in-game activities as 'routine' and not requiring his focused attention or being 'in an alert mode'.

These actions require minimal uptake from the co-participant who is engaged in the game, and lack of response is not treated as accountable. Further, when the 'dead' participant uses response-mobilizing strategies such as recipient address and question formats, only minimal verbal uptake is required by the co-participant.

Thereby, the participants organize and distribute their common engagement in the social space of the online game in ways that locally consider recent and current in-game actions and the participants' current possibilities for contributing to accomplishing a common in-game mission. Whereas one participant's presence and engagement are mainly observable and thereby potentially 'shared' through the visual representation of his avatar 'in the game', the 'dead' participant uses verbal means to manage engagement.

In sum the 'dead' teammate manages varied 'levels' of engagement, presence, intersubjectivity and even intercorporeality (through the living avatar) that are finely tuned to the practical gaming situation and events at hand. The study of these accomplishments testify to an emergent, mediated social space that gamers from the comfort of their leather chairs are constantly involved in co-constructing.

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PANEL 7: INTERACTION ON TINDER

Panel organizer: Elisabeth Muth Andersen, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

The slogan for the online dating app Tinder is: "Tinder: Match. Chat. Date". This slogan hints at how some ordinary, but often subtle and embodied social practices such as 'checking someone out' and 'getting acquainted with someone' have been digitalized on Tinder. The three-step procedure described in the slogan also implies that whatever happens in the black box of 'chatting' determines whether the participants proceed to meet or not. Therefore, along with the photos and profile texts that are also used in the 'matching' process, 'chatting' is crucial for any next step, including clarifying or negotiating the nature of the potential meeting (see Licoppe's (2020) analysis of dominant patterns of online dating interaction and in how people can conversationally project 'hookups' and 'romantic relationships' respectively).
This panel focuses on the chat-based interactions that occur between users in the Tinder app. Data consists of anonymized screenshots collected and sent by users to the researchers, and the panel discusses ethical and methodological issues related to privacy and anonymity. The data is analyzed from a 'digital CA' perspective (Giles, Stommel, Paulus, Lester, & Reed, 2015) and focuses on the interactional organization of the chats and participants' sense-making practices in their attempts at getting to know their 'matches' and determining where that should lead. Analyses presented in this panel show how profile information also presented to users in the matching process is used to launch a first topic immediately in the chat; how users design their message as recognizably responsive to the previous one; and how users design messages that recognizably project an answer using several strategies simultaneously, thus displaying a concern that the interaction might stop. Hence, the panel analyses and discusses issues of how participants work out whether to proceed or disengage and how they package their messages in ways that seem to mobilize further engagement using interactional resources specific to the digital environment of Tinder.

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DIGITALIZING METHODOLOGICAL PRACTICES: THE CASE OF TINDER DATING

Carles Roca-Cuberes, University Pompeu Fabra, Barcelona
Will Gibson, University College London, United Kingdom
Elisabeth Muth Andersen, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

This paper introduces and discusses how to do "digital CA" (Giles, Stommel, Paulus, Lester, & Reed, 2015) focusing on studying online dating practices.
Digitalization of social practices has the consequence that people accomplish social action in environments without co-presence and using resources other than talk and the other embodied resources which CA studies traditionally center on, such as gesture, gaze (Hazel, Mortensen, & Rasmussen, 2014).
Methodologically oriented papers have argued that CA techniques may be well-suited for research that studies naturally occurring digital interaction (Giles et al., 2015), for instance for comparing online and offline interaction, participants' efforts to accomplish coherence, management of trouble and more broadly understanding how social interaction is accomplished in online settings (Paulus, Warren, & Lester, 2016). By focusing on such issues, "digital CA" pays attention to participants' methods for sense-making, i.e. accomplishing a common understanding in digital settings.
We describe the process of accessing and analyzing Tinder interaction data and the challenges they pose from a digital CA perspective. Accessing Tinder interaction data requires the participation of a number of users. Participants were recruited through advertisements on social media and other digital forums
The sample was a mix of participants from urban areas which was balanced as far as possible in terms of gender and age. Once recruited, the participants – after signing informed consent forms –archived all their Tinder interactions with other users for a period of two weeks and sent them fully anonymized to the researchers in the form of screen shots.
The preparation and later analysis of Tinder interaction data poses a number of challenges too some of which may both be a member's problem and analytical problem. Among these, data lacks information about timing, text editing etc; problems with sequencing (e.g. exchanges abruptly interrupted); and limitations imposed by the architecture/affordances of the app combined with limitations of the data collection design (e.g. interaction between users might be prompted by comments on photos or profiles, inaccessible to analysts).

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WHERE TO START? INITIATING POST-MATCH TINDER CHAT CONVERSATIONS

Lynn de Rijk, Radboud University Nijmegen, Netherlands
Wyke Stommel, Radboud University Nijmegen, Netherlands

Although Tinder is one of the biggest dating apps in the world, a core feature of the platform is still scarcely researched: the chat function (but see Licoppe, 2020; Licoppe, forthcoming). When a match is established users can start a chat conversation. In this presentation we focus on how Tinder users initiate interaction with their matches.
The data consist of 97 post-match chats of 10 Dutch Tinder users. The analysis is based on digital CA (Giles et al., 2015). First, our analysis shows that initiating interaction is often done by launching a first topic, rather than by greeting, identifying or initial inquiries (cf. Schegloff, 1986). This topic is based on the profile of the "match" and thus recipient-designed (Sacks et al., 1974). Second, chats are generally opened with actions that make a response relevant (Schegloff & Sacks, 1973), such as compliments and questions regarding the profile or playful proposals alluding to a future encounter. Such first pair parts reduce the risk that the first post is ignored. Third, users orient to originality as a means to stand out, evidenced by meta-utterances about their conversation starter. Originality may apply to what is said, but also to what is "done" with the first post e.g., launching a guessing game. The interest in standing out from other candidates is also evidenced by users displaying Tinder savviness through this meta-commentary. Fourth, conversation starters may point out commonalities on the basis of profile information, even very specific or exclusive presumed shared knowledge.
So, Tinder openings are strongly tied to profile information and to flirting and/or getting to know one another. Making a response relevant is the key to initiating a potentially "effective" chat, as this gets the conversational ball rolling. Doing so in an original fashion aids in eliciting a response, making the user stand out from "the crowd".

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THE SPECTRE OF 'GHOSTING' AND THE SEQUENTIAL ORGANIZATION OF POST-MATCH TINDER CHAT CONVERSATIONS

Christian Licoppe, Telecom Paristech, Paris

I have used a conversation analysis (CA)-inspired approach to analyze the Tinder chat conversations of a sample of users in Paris. It shows how such conversations display a distinctive sequential organization in which participants: a) design turns as a combination of backward-looking interactional moves (recognizably responsive to parts of previous messages) and forward-looking ones (often questions, and almost always moves designed as first pair parts of an adjacent sequence); b) orient towards providing significant elaborations of their moves, made noticeable by the way they seem to run against the 'maxim of quantity'; c) often rely on the 'one question after another' device, in which an open question is immediately repaired or reformulated (in the same message or in the next one) into a Y/N question. Participants are accountable for not using such resources systematically. Since a recognizable function of such resources is to reinforce the way in which successive turns project an answer, their use displays a concern that the conversation might stop, and the commitment of their users to keeping the conversation going. Tinder chat conversations thus seem haunted from the inside by the possibility of interactional desertion or 'ghosting'.

PANEL 8: DIGITALIZING EDUCATION AND LEARNING

Panel organizer: Elise Seip Tönnessen, University of Agder, Norway

Digitalizing education and learning has been an ongoing process in the school system as well as in less formalized contexts of learning since the personal computer was introduced. The global pandemic that sent children and young people in a situation of learning from home, has certainly speeded up the process and raised the awareness of potentials and limitations in digital teaching and learning.
This panel addresses processes of digitalization on different levels and in different context where learning is happening, from official government documents, via learning materials and literacy practices to more informal learning contexts. Two of the papers explore digital literacy practices from inside, as it were: for the youngest learners with a focus on reading (Kvåle) and for older students with focus on assessing the creation of multimodal digital texts. The other two papers span from the most formal context, looking into how the educational system is framed digitally (Tønnessen), to learning outside the school system from digital datavisualizations (Engebretsen).
Based on this variety of perspectives the panel hopes to shed light on how digitization permeates the educational systems and learning practices.

DIGITAL RESEMIOTIZATION OF CURRICULUM. THE CASE OF THE NATIONAL CURRICULUM REFORM 2020 IN NORWAY

Elise Seip Tønnessen, University of Agder, Norway

Digitization affects all levels of the school system, including the presentation of curriculum and syllabi. The new curriculum to be initiated in the Norwegian school system from the school year 2020-2021 (Fagfornyelsen 2020) is presented in digital form and designed in ways that only work well when read from a digital medium. This is a way of communicating that sharply contrasts the curriculum of 1997, which was presented in a solid hardcover book, richly illustrated with Norwegian visual art. The materiality of the book presented this curriculum as permanent, prestigious, and linear in its way of thinking. The following curriculum (2006), however, has been gradually revised online, signaling a more fluid, dynamic attitude to the national guidelines for the school system. Contrasting the development from hardcover book to online resources, this paper will discuss the following questions:

- what additional resources are made available in the 2020 online version of the National Curriculum? How are they connected to the core curriculum; what is foregrounded and what is left in the background?
- how does the digital design guide (or confuse) the reading of the online curriculum?

- How is the model reader of the online curriculum constructed?

Based on these dimensions of analysis the paper will discuss gains and losses in the process of digitalizing the curriculum.

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DIGITALIZING LITERACY AS COMMERCIAL EDUCATIONAL SOFTWARE: ABC APPS FOR PRESCHOOL CHILDREN

Gunhild Kvåle, University of Agder, Norway

iPads have become popular digital devices for preschool children. Appstore offers a broad scope of apps, and many are promoted with the promise of learning. One genre of educational apps is ABC apps, i.e. apps which offer a curated collection of activities that producers find relevant to support the literacy development of children below/around the age of school start. ABC apps concern a topic that caregivers are likely to support children's interest in, and thus likely to be willing to pay a small amount of money for. ABC apps are therefore produced not only by 'professional' educationalists, but also a broad variety of commercial agents.

Like other semiotic technologies, tablet apps are not neutral tools, but cultural artefacts loaded with social ideas and ideals. In the case of ABC apps, ideas about literacy are prominent. Literacy is a complex social practice, but in the design of an app, some aspects of literacy are necessarily foregrounded while other are downplayed. App producers will thus, more or less intentionally, inscribe their apps with certain 'literacy theories'; «different ideas of 'the problem' and what should be done about it» (Barton 2007: 2).

By approaching the apps from the perspective of social semiotic technology studies (Djonov & van Leeuwen 2018; Zhao et al. 2014), the paper will address the digitalization of social practices of literacy in commercial educational software. What kind of literacy activities do app commercial producers choose to recontextualize in ABC apps, and how? What ideas about literacy and learning are their apps imbued with? The paper will be based on a study of commercial Norwegian ABC apps (Kvåle 2020; Kvåle in progress).

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THE PROMISE OF MULTIMODAL ASSESSMENT IN DIGITAL CLASSROOMS

Øystein Gilje, University of Oslo, Norway

The creation of multimodal compositions is an important part of composing practices outside of school, and it is gradually increasing as a literacy practice in school. During the last five years the majority of pupils in the Nordic countries have received a personal digital device, which have made it possible to produce digital multimodal texts, which incorporate several modes.

Although several different tools for multimodal analysis have been developed during the last two decades (Jewitt, 2017), it is argued that few researchers have looked at formative assessment practices of multimodal texts in formal education (Silseth & Gilje, 2019). Previous research suggests that these multimodal texts play an important part in teachers' facilitation of pupils' learning and as a tool for formative assessment (Aagaard & Lund, 2013; Campell & Feldmann, 2017).

In this paper Gilje reports on data from two research projects: Good Example of Practice (GEPP) and Multimodal Learning and Assessment Practices in School (MuLVu). What changes in assessment does the transition towards digital multimodal text demand? And how do teachers work with formative assessment during students' composing of multimodal texts?

Based upon the data from the projects and an international review of multimodal assessment, Gilje demonstrates how the digital ecology scaffolds the formative assessment process. The scaffolding takes place during face-to-face assessments, but the feedback also has a longer supporting effect since it is available for students through different audio and video recordings made by the teacher.

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POPULAR SCIENCE COMMUNICATION, DIGITAL DATA VISUALIZATIONS AND INFORMAL LEARNING

Martin Engebretsen, University of Agder, Norway

Data visualizations, in the forms of colorful graphs, charts and maps, have proliferated on public arenas for informal learning – in journalism and governmental information as well as in popular science communication (PSC) (Cairo 2016).This development is related to a growing amount of accessible data and new digital tools for presenting them in ways attractive to the eye and helpful to the mind. DVs are multimodal artefacts, where verbal, visual and numeric signs interact to reveal otherwise hidden relations, patterns and developments in big data sets.

The graphical language applied in DVs, where basic visual variables like the point, the line and the area combine to communicate complex messages, is well known among experts. However, this language is not systematically taught in school, and, thus, not equally familiar to the general public. Furthermore, the digitalization of the production process facilitates new forms of interactive and dynamic DVs, implying that conventions are steadily evolving. This situation calls for intensified research on how DV works as a semiotic and aesthetic resource on public arenas for informal learning. In the existing literature on PSC, simplicity, relevance and trust are identified as critical factors for the communication to succeed (Bauer 2009). In this presentation, I will argue that data visualizations represent a complex semiotic resource with unique affordances regarding all of these criteria.

Based on a social semiotic framework, the presentation includes a pilot analysis of a selected sample of data visualizations found on digital arenas for informal learning, as well as a methodology developed for such analysis.

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PANEL 9: FROM RAW MATERIALS TO SEMIOTIC RESOURCES FOR SENSE-MAKING

Panel organizers:
Kristian Mortensen, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark.
Spencer Hazel, Newcastle University, United Kingdom

Social semiotics and ethnomethodological conversation analysis share a view on social interaction and meaning making as constructed by assembling components such as talk, the human body, material/digital objects and graphic structures in the surround. This perspective is often referred to as multimodality (e.g., Jewitt, Bezemer & O'Halloran, 2016; Mondada, 2014). The set of potential meaning making resources results from the particular shared participation framework between interlocutors, and to the contextual configurations (Goodwin, 2000) established by them at any given moment. Whereas for instance pointing towards a document in a physically co-present social activity may be understood as projecting a turn-at-talk (Mondada, 2007), this is not necessarily the case in video-mediated interaction, where the framing of the camera/screen curtails the perceptual field of the respective interlocutors. Here, by contrast, participants may look at, open, read or point at documents on the screen that are not available to co-participants or even distinguishable from merely looking at the screen unless they are accounted for in some other way.

During moments of social interaction people are forever foraging for materials from which to fashion their contributions within their interactions with one another. In doing so, they demonstrate an immensely rich range of abilities to improvise in situ materials for constructing social action in the moment-by-moment unfolding course of interaction. But while the world-at-hand is full of materials which have communicative potential – sticks, hands, walls, bodies, paper, eyebrows, screens – the vast array of objects and their affordances would be overwhelming if every single perceivable entity were treated as a communicative resource at each and every moment. Rather, these objects act as raw materials, lying in the perceptive background, which can be mobilized as resources for meaning making by participants engaged in an interaction. In this way, every move of a hand is not immediately perceived as a gesture, every grasp of a pen is not witnessable as projecting writing, every architectural surface or material artefact is not communicating one or other message. This changes, however, the moment people mobilize any of these materials for communicative purpose. These acts of conjuring meaning from the properties of the perceivable world are central to the organization of human sociality. They allow members to manage the processing of the excessive mass of objects that make up our perceptual field, while coordinating the many challenges of interaction through the use of the materials at hand.

This panel sets out to investigate how the raw materials for constructing communication are mobilized for meaning making purposes in face-to-face and video-mediated interaction. In doing so, we consider how current societal trends towards increased adoption of online platforms for conducting our everyday business

will lead to new distributions of practices for managing our social engagement with one another.

References

LEANING FORWARD

Spencer Hazel, Newcastle University, United Kingdom
Kristian Mortensen, University of Southern Demark, Denmark

The human body is in constant motion during moments of social interaction, and video-based research on social interaction has for many years been occupied with describing how bodily aspects may act as sense-making resources (Kendon, 1990; Goodwin, 1981). However, not every change in gaze is treated as interactionally significant, not every adjustment of the body indexes some understanding of the prior action, not every self-groom is treated as communicatively relevant by co-participants (although see Goodwin & Goodwin, 1986(?); Streeck, 2020). Participants are thus creatively mobilizing 'stuff' in their perceptual environment to fashion their contributions – while categorizing others' perceptual conduct according to whether it is accountable as communication implicative or not (Streeck & Kallmeyer, 2001), thereby selecting bits and pieces as relevant components for co-participants' displays of understanding and leaving others as background features.---
In this paper, we look at instances in which a participant leans forwards towards a co-participant, either in face-to-face interaction or in an online environment. This may be a practice for various social actions, including a display of intimacy between lovers, a component of an upcoming dispute (see Goodwin, 2018: 172) or a part of the turn design of a repair initiation (Rasmussen, 2014; Pajo & Klippi, 2013; Mortensen, 2012). At times, however, it may simply be a way for rearranging the seating on a chair during a meeting that may be treated as meaningful by co-participants. Building on Kendon's notion of transactional segment (1990), we discuss how leaning forward brings the torso off balance and is thereby tied to a temporal organization (readjusting the body position, cf. Schegloff, 1998). We discuss this in light of the global increase in online interaction, and what differences there are in how this resource is perceivable.

References

MAKING MEANING UNDER THE MICROSCOPE

Jeff Bezemer, University College London, United Kingdom
Arpan Tahim, University College London, United Kingdom

We explore an example from a video recording in which two surgeons jointly suture together two blood vessels under the microscope. The microscope frames a very small area of interest, offering a shared, magnified, 'tunnel' view of the anatomical structures they intend to manipulate –the vessels- and the (tips of) the instruments used for manipulation, with some larger structures being visible in the background. While looking through the microscope, the surgeons don't see anything else—a feature that sets this form of digitally mediated interaction apart from e.g. video conferencing; and that, we argue, has a direct bearing on the question of when a 'movement' becomes a 'gesture', i.e., a 'social action'; or 'sign'). What is within the microscope's frame is available for close mutual monitoring: it makes even the smallest of the surgeon's physical interventions and their effects on the objects being manipulated visible. As we shall show, in this context, each noticeable movement (including movements of the vessels) becomes meaningful, and a critical resource for the coordination of work. What's more, the surgeons appear to work on the assumption that the movements that they are (directly or indirectly) responsible for are indeed being scrutinized by the other. Thus, the significance of movement appears to be presumed by both the movement-observer and the movement-maker. We conclude by highlighting the need to recognize how parties to interaction frame an area of interest (e.g. through a microscope or camera), and how that frame shapes the semiotic status of movements visible within it.

GRAPHICAL STRUCTURES AS MEANING-BEARING ELEMENTS IN SOCIAL INTERACTION

Nathalie Schümchen, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

In institutional settings centered around group work, repair sequences frequently occur in relation to the task at hand. In institutional interactions where groups of students are asked to collaboratively make sense of, for instance, a task written on a worksheet, the worksheet (the inscribed object), becomes the locus of shared attention and the text on the worksheet thereby the potential repairable.
In the present analysis, I describe repair sequences in which the repairable is not made up of text but rather a more complex combination of text and other graphical structures. The worksheets, that dyads of participants work on, consist of several written-down sentences which are accompanied by, or superimposed with, iconic representations of the respective sentence's intonation pattern. The participants' task is to analyze the structures in order to produce the desired pronunciation of the

sentences. In the course of the task, the participants negotiate the meaning of the graphical structures and how those should be translated into a specific verbal production of the sentences.
Thereby, I demonstrate the role of inscribed objects in interaction, specific graphical structures as meaning-bearing elements in social interaction in particular.

TELLING OR SEEING THE SEX OF THE FŒTUS IN PRE-NATAL ULTRASOUND SCANNING CONSULTATIONS

Christian Licoppe, Telecom ParisTech, France
Luca Greco, Université de Lorraine, France
Nicolas Rollet, Telecom ParisTech, France

One aspect of the panel deals with the way features of the environment may be made relevant as resources in interaction. There are different ways to do that. For instance, when referring to some jointly available features in a shared ecology for interaction participants can refer to it in talk, or rely on ostensive practices (noticing, pointing, showing, etc.) to see it jointly in a certain way. We study here these two different modalities in sequences which deal with recognizing the gender of a foetus in pre-natal ultrasound scanning consultations (which appear as a feature on screen), based on an EM/CA inspired analysis of video recordings. These consultations constitute a 'perspicuous setting' for 'seing-together'. However we show how such recognition may emerge according to two very different trajectories, one based on 'informings' (the physician 'tells' the gender of the foetus to the parent(s)), and the other based on 'seing-together' or 'showings' (The physician somehow guides, and collaborates with, the parent(s) so as to achieve a joint visual recognition of the gender). These two different trajectories enact different kinds of epistemic work (along the dual dimensions of propositional knowledge and professional vision), of participation frames, and of modes of (de)coupling of talk-in-interaction with available features of the local ecologies. Though this constitutes a very particular setting, it also illustrates a much more general issue: what are the different ways to refer to a publicly available object or feature of a shared environment and make it relevant to an ongoing interaction, and how are they managed?

PANEL 10: ROBOTS AND AI IN SHOPPING INTERACTION – INTERACTIONAL PERSPECTIVES ON THE TECHNOLOGICAL ASSISTANCE OF AI/ROBOTICS IN PHYSICAL SHOPPING AND SALES INTERACTION

Panel organizer: Antonia Krummheuer, Aalborg University, Denmark

This panel explores the interactional construction of assistance in physical shopping and sales interaction of people using AI-technology or robotic platforms. In recent years, more and more research projects develop interactive shopping technologies with the aim of assisting people in their shopping activities. This technological assistance is provided in physical (and not online) shopping or sales interactions, in which e.g. a human assistant is not available or shoppers are in special need of help due to limited physical, communicative or cognitive resources . Examples are social assistive robots supporting navigation or decision-making, interactive trolleys for the transportation of goods, or AI-scanners.
Within Engineering the evaluation of shopping robots focusses mainly on the user's experiences (Aaltonen et al., 2017; Alves et al., 2018; Chen et al., 2017; Doering et al., 2015; Gharpure & Kulyukin, 2008; Iwamura et al., 2011; Neves et al., 2019; Niemelä, Arvola, et al., 2017; Niemelä, Heikkilä, et al., 2017). These approaches miss to explore the interactional and multimodal construction of technical assistance in situated encounters, that can be provided by interaction analysis (Crabtree et al., 2012; Suchman, 2007). Within ethnomethodology and conversation analysis various studies have investigated interactional management of sales and shopping interaction (Clark et al., 1994; Clark & Pinch, 2010; De Stefani, 2013, 2014; Heath & Luff, 2007; Llewellyn, 2016; Llewellyn & Hindmarsh, 2013; Meinhof, 2017; Stokoe et al., 2017; vom Lehn, 2014). A detailed analysis of shopping/sales interaction with assistive technologies, however, is missing.

Therefore, this panel aims to understand the sequential and multimodal construction of assistance in physical technologically supported shopping and sales interaction. We aim to explore:

- How do human and technology notice, recognize and react to each other's activities as potentially meaningful for interaction?
- Can we describe a sequential and multimodal organization of joint activities such as expression of choice, recruitment of assistance, decision-making, and/or navigation?
- How are special configurations and/or material objects made relevant in the ongoing interaction?
- How does the commercial and assistive context become salient in the interaction?
- How can interactional studies on shopping interaction with assistive technologies inform both practices of assistance and/or the design of assistive technologies?

THE PRAXEOLOGY OF BYPASSING OCULAR-CENTRIC SPATIAL RELATIONS: HOW VISUALLY IMPAIRED PEOPLE USE AI MOBILE OBJECT RECOGNITION WHEN SHOPPING.

Brian Due, University of Copenhagen, Denmark
Rikke Nielsen, University of Copenhagen, Denmark
Louise Lüchow, University of Copenhagen, Denmark

This paper explores physical shopping conducted by visually impaired people using AI-technology in their smartphones. Based on computer vision and object recognition, smartphones can be used to scan objects and provide their user with verbal information about them. However, mobile scanning involves highly complex embodied actions. A perspicuous setting for studying the ordered complexity of object-scanning are when visually impaired people goes shopping, using their phones with object-recognition functionalities to scan grocery products. Whereas sighted people can adjust a handheld camera to an object using their vision, thus unnoticeably accomplishing a scanning, visually impaired people are observably orienting to the required actions for the accomplishment of a successful scan. Thus, studying visually impaired people enables us to establish new understandings about the spatial relation between the body, the object and the environment thus contributing to new insights into the use of new AI technology and the interactional and situational practices which are involved.

The paper is based on data from the BlindTech project, an ongoing video ethnographic study of visually impaired people's daily lives and usage of new technologies in Denmark. Data is analyzed using ethnomethodological multimodal conversation analysis (Streeck et al., 2011). The analysis provides evidence for what we suggest to call the praxeology of bypassing ocular-centric spatial relations, a study of how blind people navigate in a visual dominant world. Cognitive aspects of spatial relations have been described extensively in neuropsychological research (Postma & Ham, 2016). However, spatial relations, i.e. the relation between sensory systems and objects in space, are firstly direct, non-representational and action-based (Gibson, 2002; Briscoe & Grush, 2020). We show how establishing an object-space relation is an observable situated achievement. Findings in the paper relates to embodied actions: a) holding the phone correctly in the hand, b) finding the correct angle of the camera, c) finding the correct distance to the object, d) holding the object in the correct angle and position and e) understanding the intrinsic nature of the object. We show just how visually impaired people accomplish these in-action as locally produced phenomena of order.

References

ARE YOU SURE YOU WANT TO BUY THAT?' - REJECTION AND DESELECTION IN ROBOT ASSISTED SHOPPING INTERACTION

Antonia Krummheuer and Matthias Rehm, Aalborg University, Denmark

Algorithms for online shopping aim not only to support the customer in finding the product he or she looks after, but also by offering more (similar) choices. Even though the algorithms are able to adjust to individual preferences, they are designed for the benefit of the seller as they invite the customer to select more products. In certain settings, however, not the selection but the de-selection of goods is of utmost importance. In our video-ethnographic research on assisted shopping in health care settings, we found that care personnel supporting people with acquired brain injury (ABI) negotiate and sometimes even reject the 'purchasability' of a certain product. These negotiations are based on (institutional) considerations regarding the appropriateness of a given choice and it's consequences, e.g. if it's use might be dangerous or the price extends the individual's budget.

Therefore, we shift the focus to the development of assistive technologies aiming for the deselection of goods and explore how assistive technologies can support the deselection of goods. This can be relevant e.g. in regard to health questions or in regard to questions of buying more sustainable products. The paper will firstly, show how we used multimodal analysis to describe negotiation of choices in assisted shopping interaction, and secondly, how these insights were used to build an embodied and conversational dialog system for an assistive shopping robot that helps people to de-select a chosen product. The paper will end by presenting first findings of the analyses of interactions with the robot prototype used to understand the interactional consequences of the assistive technology for shopping interaction.

CHOOSING OBJECTS IN REMOTE SHOPPING. ACHIEVING 'INSPECTABLE VIEWS' THROUGH MOBILE CONFIGURATIONS AND CAMERA MANIPULATION

Karola Pitsch, Universität Duisburg-Essen, Germany
Akiko Yamazaki, Saitama University, Japan
Keiichi Yamazaki, Saitama University, Japan
Hisato Fukuda, Saitama University, Japan
Kouyou Otsu, Saitama University, Japan

This paper explores how participants, who are situated in a remote location, attempt to locate and choose 'buyables products' (de Stefani 2013, 2014) in a small stationary

shop. The analysis is part of an interdisciplinary project which aims at developing a remote shopping support system (i.e. a robotic shopping trolley) which should allow elderly participants to manage their shopping duties from home. A particular challenge consists in providing and negotiating access for the remote person to both gain an overview of a particular product category and to zoom in on a specific product for close inspection.

In preparation for the robotic system, we conducted a study at a small German stationary shop during which two participants (remote shoppers) were located at a remote site and were given access to the shop via two cameras (audio/video-link) inside the shop. One of these cameras – i.e. a mobile phone camera – was handheld by a person acting as shopping assistant in the stationary shop, the other camera – i.e. a 360° camera – was attached to a shopping trolley which, in turn, was pushed through the store by a second person acting as shopping assistant. Both camera views were transferred to the remote site and displayed on a large screen. While the manipulation of the mobile phone camera was physically realized by the shopping assistant only, the remote shoppers could control the 360° trolley camera with a joystick, in addition to the shopping assistant manipulating the trolley.

Our analysis will explore how these four participants manage collaboratively to provide 'inspectable views' and appropriate mobile configurations so that the remote shoppers can actively engage in choosing a 'buyable product'. A closer understanding of these practices will provide us with insights into developing algorithms for the robotic trolley platform for how to create spatial formations, and will help us, at the same time, to gain an understanding of how both human participants (Krummheuer 2020), but also the robotic system might limit, through its conduct, the remote shoppers' choices.

References

DEALING WITH A SOCIAL ROBOT IN PUBLIC ENCOUNTERS. FORMS OF ENGAGEMENT IN HRI OF CUSTOMERS AND PROFESSIONALS IN A COMMERCIAL SETTING

Julia Velkovska, Orange Labs/SENSE and EHESS/CEMS, Paris

The history of customer relationships is basically the history of their progressive technological equipment and transformation trough industrialization (call centers), automation (artificial conversational agents [Velkovska and Beaudouin 2014]) and digitalization (online customer communities, digital customers' self-care communities, [Velkovska 2015]). This history of the automation of the customer relationships shows that each new technological mediation aims at cost reducing by delegating a part of employees' tasks to other actors (external economic actors, machines or customers)

and leads to more and more impersonal interactions. Will the introduction of social robotics in sales interaction constitute continuity or a break regarding to the previous forms of customer relationship automation?
The paper addresses this question building on a video-ethnographic study of human-robot interactions in a commercial setting. Spoon, a robot described by its designers as "social", "emotional", "empathic" and also "sympathic", was put for three months period during the autumn of 2018 in a telephone and IT shop in the center of Paris with the mission "to help" sales advisors to receive customers and answer their first questions (like orientation in this big two-floor shop, how to meet an advisor etc.). Specifically the paper questions: How the public availability of the system is treated by customers and by employees in the shop? How do people engage in interaction with the robot? What is the robot's contribution, if any, to advisors' work? What are the emerging forms of coordination? To explore these questions the paper draws on an ethnomethodologcial ethnography investigating the uses of the robot "in the wild" during its three months stay in the shop in the middle of customers and employees. The data collected are composed of video recordings of HRI in natural situation involving customers and employees, in addition with observation ethnographical notes, interviews with customers, advisers and managers and photos. The first findings shed light on noticeable properties of collaboration in HRI that will be discussed

References

PANEL 11: DIGITAL HEALTH PRACTICES

Panel organizer: Anette Grønning, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

Media and digital technologies are constantly influencing and changing health practices by introducing new digital solutions, such as digital communication encounters, website portals, and applications. The COVID-19 pandemic has caused further rapid changes to the healthcare system, wherein digital health solutions have become more relevant than ever. This panel will focus on health practices in the digital media landscape, including research on health systems, health professionals, and patients. Questions that will be addressed include: How do patients and health professionals use and perceive digital health solutions, such as messaging systems and applications? How do we conduct innovative and socially relevant research within the fields of human health and digital health?
In the first presentation, professor Anthony Smith will take us on a journey to explore the way digital health (telehealth) is being used in Australia for a broad range of clinical services in different settings. In the second presentation, professor Srikant Sarangi will critically reflect on the interface between expertise and expert systems with regard to patients' e-health literacy. In the third presentation, professor Helena Sandberg will explain the need for more collaboration between health sciences and media and communication scholars. Her colleague, Yukun You, will present a case study on sleep based on analysis of how young people in China engage with sleep-regulating applications. Finally, research director Anette Grønning and colleagues will present highlights from the Danish project 'Digital Consultations', which focuses on the use and perceptions of email consultations in general practice. To close, we will encourage all participants to engage in a discussion about future research perspectives on digital health practices.

IT TOOK A PANDEMIC - TO MAKE TELEHEALTH A HOUSEHOLD NAME

Anthony Smith, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

In the right circumstances, telehealth can save people having to travel extensive distances to access specialist health services. This is especially important for people living in rural and remote areas of the country, and for people who have difficulty travelling away from home. Despite the obvious advantages of telehealth, its routine uptake in Australia has been somewhat slower than expected. However, the onset of the COVID-19 pandemic has all of a sudden caused rapid change in our health system and made telehealth a household name. Since March 2020, we have seen exponential growth in the use of telehealth around the world. This presentation will take you on a journey, which explores the way telehealth is being used for a broad range of clinical services in different settings; barriers and enablers associated with telehealth implementation and sustainability; common myths related to telehealth; and an

overview of how telehealth is being used in the Australian public health system – before and during the pandemic.
The Centre for Online Health (COH) is Australia's leading academic centre in telehealth, with 20 years' experience developing, implementing and evaluating telehealth services in diverse contexts. The Centre's expertise in telehealth research, education and teaching, service delivery, and consultancy services is internationally recognised. The COH multidisciplinary team of clinicians, academic researchers, health economists, educators, technicians, engineers, and administrators, bring together a broad mix of skills to telehealth. Their mission is to enable better healthcare and stronger communities through practical telehealth solutions.

PATIENTS' PROTO-PROFESSIONALISM IN THE E-HEALTH ERA

Srikant Sarangi, Aalborg University, Denmark

The contemporary society is characterized as 'the information age', which logically extends to what may be labelled 'the health information age'. The internet-mediated information revolution has led to different trajectories of science communication including the public health domain as well as healthcare delivery such as digital consultations, electronic patient records, mobile health apps, e-health forums, blogs, ask-the-expert websites and multi-professional video conferences. Accompanying these changes in practices, over the years, language and communication researchers have engaged to study the transformed modalities occasioned by and mediated through information communication technology in the healthcare domain.
Several scholars are sceptical about the ascendancy of technology in healthcare practice, claiming how users of technology – doctors and patients alike – redefine their own goals beyond the so-called 'best interests', thus disrupting the conventional knowledge asymmetries underpinning the doctor-patient relationship. In the worst case scenario, technology ceases to serve the purposes of their users.
A significant development afforded by internet-based technology is the increased level of patients' e-health literacy and, consequently, democratisation of expertise. This amounts not only to accessing health information digitally, but also the phenomenon of patients 'doctoring' themselves in 'the now of its presence', i.e. 'expert patients' becoming instrumental in self-diagnosis and even self-treatment. The extent to which lay doctoring – or what I refer to as proto-professionalism – reduces the professional-lay divide in minimizing the gap between 'the voice of medicine' and 'the voice of the lifeworld' is open to debate. In this presentation, I critically reflect on the interface between expertise and expert systems vis-à-vis patients' e-health literacy and suggest that multi-layered distributed expertise in the healthcare domain is far more complex than constituting 'active participation' and 'empowerment'.

HEALTH PROMOTION AND HEALTH PRACTICES IN THE DIGITAL MEDIA LANDSCAPE

Helena Sandberg, Halmstad University and Lund University, Sweden
Yukun You, Lund University, Sweden

Media and digital technologies influence every sector of society and permeates our professional activities as well as our personal everyday life. They affect information search, communication, culture, identities, also, our health and wellbeing in multiple ways. They offer opportunities for health professionals to reach out, and engage with various audiences for health promotion purposes. Digital technology is used also for medical reasons to control and surveil people's bodies and health behaviors. In this presentation, we will address health in the new digital media landscape and raise critical questions on the role of digital media and technology in people's lives from a health educationist approach, and from a media and communication studies approach, by high lightening some results from two different studies. 1) A review of health communication research commissioned by the National Health Agency of Sweden, based on 233 peer reviewed scientific articles (2011-2016). The review raises critical questions on why media and communication theory is rarely used in health promotion efforts, and points toward a need for more collaboration between health sciences and media and communication scholars. 2) A case study on sleep, a crucial part of a healthy life, and the gamificiation of sleep through the widely used Chinese mobile app SleepTown. Through semi-structured interviews with twelve young users in China, we take a closer look at how people engage with sleep-regulating apps and make sense of their sleeping/gaming practices in the physical and virtual space. The study draws from social and media theories; the interdisciplinary field of gamification, Foucauldian notions of governmentality and surveillance, media engagement theory, and Actor-Network Theory. The case study highlights an interesting tension in the encouragements to use digital technology in order to stay away from digital technology, sometimes referred to as digital detox.

EMAIL CONSULTATIONS AND DIGITAL HEALTH IN DENMARK

Anette Grønning, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

The social practices around visiting a general practitioner (GP) have changed significantly within the last ten years. Today, going to see your doctor might be through a physical consultation in the clinic (or, on rarer occasions, a home visit), a telephone conversation, an e-mail consultation, or a video encounter. In Denmark, it has been mandatory for all GPs to offer email consultations since 2009 in order to 'support efficiency and quality through the digitisation of health care' (Doctor's Agreement, 2010). Email consultations were introduced as a cost-effective and

convenient means of obtaining quick access to a GP, primarily for renewal of prescriptions, communication of test results, or quick questions. As a form of communication that has different constraints than face-to-face communication, digital consultations afford benefits and present new challenges. Successful communication between patients and GPs is essential to support both the relationship between them and the making of correct medical decisions. Between 2008 and 2019, the number of email consultations in Denmark increased from 1.3 million to 7.2 million per year, equating to just under 21% of all GP consultations. Aged patients (65–89 years) are the most frequent participants in these digital consultations. Based on qualitative research (interviews, observation, and analysis of emails), our research group will present highlights from the project 'Digital Consultations' (SDU), 2018–2021 and include a brief perspective on video consultation as the latest consultation form in Denmark. The overall research question of the project is: How do digital consultations influence the roles of aged patients, GPs, and their asymmetric, mutual relationship? The project contains five sub-projects that share three key perspectives of varying significance: technology, content, and relations. The research project is funded by the VELUX Foundations.

References

PANEL 12: DIGITALIZING MUSEUM PRACTICES: RESEMIOTIZING NEW ROLES FOR MUSEUMS

Panel organizer: Louise Ravelli, University of New South Wales, Australian

Museums have always been resemiotizers of social practice: the social practices of collecting, classifying, curating, and presenting, among others. This panel addresses the multiple ways in which museums engage in this resemiotization, exploring both the history of this enterprise and its 21st century transformations in the light of both digital technologies and the Covid pandemic. We will examine how museum practices and their transformations intersect with the physical architecture of museums, their online presence, multisensorial experience for visitors, and the impact of new realities for ethics in a museum context.

FROM CURIOUS CABINETS TO SHOUTY ICONS: RESEMIOTIZATION AS THE CORE OF MUSEUM PRACTICE

Louise Ravelli, University of New South Wales, Australia

As museums have developed and changed over time, there has been an interesting alignment of core social practices with the physical spaces that characterise museums. The original cabinets of curiosity of the 16th-18th centuries were for intimate, invitation-only viewing, to showcase the spoils of private collecting by the wealthy. As well as actual cabinets, the term 'cabinet' also refers to rooms which were filled with objects of curiosity, their main function being to display or 'show off' acquisitions, knowledge, and taste. As this largely private practice gradually transformed to become a public one, colonial expansion provided the plunder to fill large, state-based institutions, such as the British Museum, which impressed with their order and regulation: institutions which were divided into galleries, galleries divided into exhibits, exhibits divided into displays. As Tony Bennett has documented in The Birth of the Museum: History, theory, politics (Routledge, 1995), these structures had an important function to regulate behaviour and educate the masses. In the late 20th and early 21st centuries, a gradual decline in public funding, concomitant with the availability of mass travel and competition for the tourist dollar, has coincided with the prevalence of 'iconic' buildings; architectural marvels which embrace the visitor and which invite wonder in an entirely different way. At the same time, visitors are no longer 'told' what to know, but invited to consider multiple possibilities and voices. Digitalization adds yet further layers of change, disturbing the borders of the physical and not-physical, the 'authentic' and the 'reproduced'. While this is a blunt sweep through a complex and multifaceted history, it highlights that resemiotization has always been at the core of the nature of museums as semiotic institutions. As social

practices change through digitilization and the impacts of Covid, the nature of museums can be seen to be changing again.

References

MUSEUMS ONLINE: REPRESENTATION AND POSITIONING ON ART MUSEUM WEBSITES

Jennifer Blunden, State Library of New South Wales, Australia

Over recent decades, museum websites have dramatically expanded their scope and role, developing from relatively straightforward marketing tools used to promote programs and give practical 'visit' information to become virtual museums in themselves. Today, museum websites are portals to entire collections. They are digital archives for research, resources and a plethora of institutional activities. They are interactive learning environments, creative spaces, social spaces. Over the past 12 months, as Covid-19 triggered lockdowns around the globe and art museums closed their doors, many turned to their websites as a means of connecting with audiences isolated by social distancing and providing work for artists, sparking a new wave of expansion and transformation. But what are they actually saying about art and artists, about the visitor and themselves?
This talk looks at how the representation and positioning of these four key participants has changed over time – and continues to change -- in one art museum website relative to institutional goals of engaging diverse audiences with art. It draws on a research residency at the Metropolitan Museum of Art in New York, which explored how visitor experience and understanding were shaped by the various interpretive resources offered.

SHARING EXPERIENCE IN A VIRTUAL/PHYSICAL EXHIBITION

Palmyre Pierroux, University of Oslo, Norway

In museums today, screen-based interactions with curated content are increasingly part of the rich semiotic environments that mediate visitors' meaning making. One result of this development is the introduction into gallery spaces of new modalities that engage multiple senses and invite new types of movement, gesture, discourse, and social interaction. How may studies of interactions in new museum 'mediascapes' contribute to multisensory and embodied perspectives on meaning making? In this talk, I reflect on how this question has been addressed in a recent design-based study of an immersive exhibition in a national architecture museum. This study explored how

senses may be enhanced in virtual environments to "make sense" of architecture, and how visitors interacted to create joint attention and co-presence as they bodily moved through parallel realities (virtual/physical). The exhibition experiment was the outcome of an interdisciplinary university–museum research collaboration, involving partners with similar interests in how VR technologies may foster real multisensory, visuospatial experiences of architecture in a museum setting.

NEW WORLD ORDER: MUSEUMS ONLINE, MULTIMODALITY AND ETHICS

Sophia Diamantopolou, University College London, United Kingdom
Sofia Paschou, Ionian University, Greece
Georgios Papaioannou, University College London, United Kingdom

The new communicational landscape emerging in response to public health and safety measures due to Covid-19 has moved the museum even further into the digital domain in new roles. Amidst the overall radical shift to the digital and online, coupled with a blurring of boundaries between the private and the public lives of citizens, museums have re-emerged and reconstituted themselves as digital online entities facilitating communication. This paper uses examples from UK and USA museums to sketch this new museum landscape that places renewed emphasis on visitor participation, the creation of a museum digital community and the presentation of digital content as an alternative to the experience of physical collections.
During the pandemic times of significantly enhanced online provision, museums have been inviting more extensive visitor engagement to serve lockdown-ed communities. Museums have employed a wider range of platforms, such as TikTok and YouTube, and have extended their activities on their existing Facebook, Twitter and Instagram accounts. However, this enhanced digital impact has left museums and visitors ethically exposed and challenged. The intensity of online communication practices has implications arising from the diverse terms of usage of digital media that museums endorse, and visitors agree to comply with. This has resulted in an unprecedented and sudden accumulation of Big data requiring immediate and effective management as well as new levels of permissions and ethical assurances.

The paper uses examples of Facebook and Twitter postings by museums and visitors that arise in response to the 'Black Lives Matter' movement and applies a multimodal discourse analysis approach. The paper argues that the new state of affairs and communication practices should move towards the adoption of a new discourse; that of the multimodal and ethical online museum. The prompt of social movements such as 'Black lives matter' in conjunction with the museum's enhanced digital presence has made more visible the need for museums to: a) initiate mechanisms for ethical assurance that are globally valued and protect digital citizenship and b) accord

recognition to the multimodally realised discursive positions and views of the visitors as a significant part of their identity and personal data.

PANEL 13: MONDADA, L.: TBA

PANEL 14: DIGITALIZED CONSUMPTION: CREDIT, HEALTH, AND SPECTACLE FROM A CONSUMER RESEARCH PERSPECTIVE

Niklas Woerman, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

Mangler et overordnet abstract

DIGITALIZED ENCOUNTERS IN THE AFFECTIVE ECONOMY OF MICROCREDIT

Domen Bajde, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

I investigate how digitalized encounters between internet users and micro-entrepreneurs featured on microlending platforms, such as Kiva.org., sustain the 'affective economy' (Ahmed 2004) of microcredit. Through digitalized encounters lenders and borrowers are constituted as aspirational subjects (Raco 2008), who are to be empowered by loans, and who can (at least in the case of lenders) reaffirm their affinity and connection with other hardworking agents of change through loans. I discuss the affirmative and relational potential of digitalized encounters, as well as how digitalized encounters reinforce global inequalities.

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THE DIGITALIZATION OF HEALTH-RELATED EVERYDAY PRACTICES

Anna Schneider-Kamp, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

This line of work aims to understand the impact of the integration of digital technology on the client-professional relationship through a perspective on emotional and relational labour. It draws on a qualitative study of the introduction of an mHealth platform into the care processes of a social psychiatry out-patient setting. The study demonstrates how technology acceptance is facilitated by familiarity and relational trust, how the platform optimizes the execution of routine tasks by establishing a context of mutual control and autonomy, and how the platform allows for a multi-channel approach to interactional care. The analysis reveals a new type of care interaction, which appears to strengthen the client-professional relationship by lightening the burden of emotional labour. The findings provide insights on the further development of the theoretical conceptualisation of emotional labour in times of on-going digitalisation.

SYNTHETIC RITUALS. EVENT LIVESTREAMS AND THE DIGITALIZATION OF SPECTACLE

Niklas Woermann, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

In the age of social distancing, mass events like music festivals or soccer matches need to be moved online but often struggle to retain the authentic atmosphere of a stadium, the emotional entrainment of ecstatic crowds, or the excited anticipation of live encounters. I present a video-aided ethnography of the professional staging of eSport tournaments for online livestreams
as a case study of highly successful digital commercial spectacles. Drawing on Goffmanian ritual theory and Knorr Cetina's notion of the synthetic situation, I theorize event livestreams as synthetic rituals and show how key ritual elements such as body, audience, artifact and script are synthetically staged to re-create key ritual qualities such as embodiment, fatefulness, and liveness for online audiences. I sketch implications for cultural industries industry and interaction ritual theory in the age of screen encounters.

PANEL 15: JOINING HUMANISTIC AND TECHNICAL PERSPECTIVES ON DIGITALIZATION

Panel organizer: Søren Vigild Poulsen, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

Software is increasingly digitalizing and automating our professional and private lives, and using software has become part and parcel of how we communicate and interact in contempory society. It follows that software is not only an essential tool in many social practices; it also restructures and transforms these. While critical humanistic studies of the user side of software bloom, an analytical perspective on the engineering side is still emerging. One appeared reason for this slow development stems from that fact that critical software engineering requires technical skills that most humanistic researchers do not possess.
In this panel, we want to address needed aspects of a research agenda for the design and production side of software and discuss if, why and how humanistic scholars need to work together with researchers from technical disciplines to solve potential and actual problems with software that aims to digitalize social practices.

SOCIAL MEDIA PLATFORM ARCHITECTURES AND THE DIGITALIZATION OF PRACTICES. A DISCURSIVE APPROACH TO THE STUDY OF TECHNICAL DOCUMENTATION.

Ilaria Moschini, Università di Firenze, Italy

Social media are key actors in digitalization processes as they offer services to billions of users that span from information and communication tools to resources that are activated or meant to be used in specific contexts, such as in the case of elections (e.g. Facebook Voting Information Center), natural disasters (e.g. Facebook Safety Check) or in commercial transactions (e.g. Weixin/WeChat payment services). The digitalization of practices in social media is highly influenced by the structure of these media, which is characterized by platform architectures (Helmond 2015) that have been defined "walled gardens" (Arora 2014) to describe the way they shape accessibility in commodified environments and have been widely criticized as a move away from the open Web and for collecting and processing users' data (Berners-Lee 2010, van Dijck 2013). With the spreading of Chinese social platforms across their national borders (Kemp 2020), the competition among nations for transformations in such data-driven technologies has increased sharply. It is a crucial competition for the impact that these technologies have on a country's GDP (Kaan 2020), but also as it further challenges the ideational equation between digital technologies and liberal values (Moschini 2013).
In order to investigate the influence of platform architectures on social media digitalization of practices, the paper proposes to combine tools from humanistic and

technological approaches to study technical documentation, which describes how services are implemented and what kind of data are exchanged among participants, being them physical actors or system components. In details, the paper combines a critical multimodal approach to discourse analysis (Machin 2013, van Leeuwen 2014) and a framework that integrates social semiotics with platform studies (Moschini 2018) to compare the documentation of two of the most popular social media platforms at a global level (Clement 2020): Facebook (2603 millions of active users) and Weixin/WeChat (1203 millions of active users). The aim is to understand how the two digital eco-systems are structured by examining the main services that are offered and how the systems interact with external participants and by analyzing how the different participants are framed and if different socio-political/socio-cultural discourses emerge from their use of semiotic resources.

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THE PAINTERLY VOICE. IDEOLOGY IN THE DEVELOPMENT OF BRUSH CONTROL INTERFACES FOR PAINTING APPS.

Christian Mosbæk Johannessen, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

This panel calls for a discussion of the design and production side of software, specifically why humanistic scholars need to collaborate with researchers from technical disciplines. In this paper, I will try to answer the call by comparing and discussing two iPad apps for painting "with data" (Rabe, 2013); Steve Sprang's 2006 "Brushes" and Adobe's 2016 "Sketch". Couched in John Bateman's (2021) suggestions for describing the material constraints on multimodal phenomena, the paper further develops van Leeuwen and Johannessen's (Johannessen & Van Leeuwen, 2017; Van Leeuwen & Johannessen, under review) notion of trace quality and trace dynamics to compare how the apps afford the user's design of painterly voice differently. I argue that these choices on the part of the software developers express different values and ideologies. It is, however, difficult to get to the bottom of such considerations because software is proprietary and developers such as Steve Sprang and Adobe's development teams do not give interviews.

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HUMANIZING SOFTWARE

Torben Worm, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

Software has moved from being mainly concerned with automating tedious tasks, or replacing typewriters, etc., to impacting every aspect of our lives through e.g. social media and its omnipresence on our mobile devices. Therefore understanding what can be done with software is essential to assert the potential impact software may have on our lives.

Since the dawn of software engineering and development some fundamental properties of software has made the exchange of knowledge and understanding of the software inherently difficult (Brooks, 1995). Software is complex and large parts of software is invisible. Furthermore software and computer science is based on a mathematical and natural science foundation and reasoning, making the fundamental understanding to some extend depending on understanding these reasoning systems and formalisms as well.

End-users have been increasingly involved in development through modern agile development methods where the focus moves from understanding the software internals to understanding the usage scenarios and interaction with the software which brings people not familiar with computers closer to the development (Sommervile, 2016). However, the interaction with the development is mainly through what is visible, i.e. the user interface, and not through understanding what is possible, e.g. the artificial intelligence and the algorithms underlying the user interface.

The idea of software being more "human" dates back a long time, e.g. Literate Programming (Knuth,1992) that aimed at software being readable as a novel you could bring to the beach. Dijkstra already addressed this in the context of programming in 1972: "... the tools we try to use and the languages or notation we are using to express or record our thoughts, are the major factors determining what we can think or express at all!" (Dijkstra, 1972). The problem here is, however, not to understand computer programs per se, but to understand what is possible through computers, and how we can construct or develop a common language to reason about it.

Communicating software potentials is only one side of the equation. Being able to understand the human implications of those potentials on humans and human behaviour is the other side. The common language we need to develop must therefore bridge the two sides of this equation.

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‘SEMIOTIC SOFTWARE ENGINEERING’ – A NEW FIELD OF SEMIOTIC TECHNOLOGY RESEARCH?

Søren Vigild Poulsen, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark,

This paper presents reflections on how to study the design of software programs that so far have been an under-researched area of semiotic technology. In that last ten years, this emerging research field within multimodal social semiotics has explored the design, use, histories, and discourses of technologies for making meaning (e.g., O’Halloran, 2009; Djonov & van Leeuwen, 2011). Objects of analysis include, but are not limited to, physical tools like graphic and engraving kits and materials as well as digital artefacts of various kinds. Especially, software programs like PowerPoint, Word and social media have been explored, as such semiotic devices structure much of the contemporary world. Despite its innovative inquiries, nature, current works have primarily looked at semiotic software from a user perspective. In doing so, it risks subscribing to ‘screen essentialism’ (Waldrip-Fruin 2009, 3; quoted in Berry 2011, 36). For this very reason, leading scholars like Djonov and van Leeuwen (2018) has called for further research of the production side of software. There is a timely and urgent need to address the design and production of the software and their impact on digitalization of people’s social life, for instance a critical scrutiny of ideas of the ‘social life’ that are built into digital technologies. This kind of research agenda should concern both the semiotic practice(s) of ‘software engineering’, including artefacts for software production, the software programs that are produced in this process, as well as how the semiotic work of software engineering relates to the user side of software and other semiotic practices. This paper proposes a sub-area of semiotic software studies that I call ‘semiotic software engineering’; it seeks to merge insights and methodologies from semiotic technology, but also departs from previous work by having a more semiotically-informed technical interest in software, with other semiotic approaches to software (e.g. Nadin, 1988), human-computer interaction (de Souza, 2005), and computation (Tanaka-Ishii, 2010). Also, this area also is deeply informed by digitial humanties, and critical code studies (Marino, 2020) that have encountered and addressed many of the issues, both theoretical, methodological, and analytical, now facing studies of the design of semiotic software. The paper presents a research agenda, that also include critiques of such an enterprise (e.g. Bateman, 2008).

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PANEL 16: MONDADA, L.: TBA

PANEL 17: DIGITALIZING WORK PRACTICES – A STRATEGIC, TACTICAL AND OPERATIONAL PERSPECTIVE

Panel organizer: Anne-Christine Rosfeldt Lorentzen, Aarhus University, Denmark
Moderator: Andrea Carugati, Aarhus University, Denmark

We will have a ninety-minute program with three speakers given 20 minutes each to speak. Moderator will summarize panel talks for the audience and have two to three planned questions to start the audience discussion. The panel will allocate generous time for audience participation and discussion.
The panel will address how work and social practices change in a world of human-AI hybrid configurations. We explore different perspectives on this question - a strategic level (top management), a tactical level (middle management), and an operational level (doctors, advisors, and customers, patients, citizens) – in relation to challenges and decision-making processes connected to the introduction of AI in work processes. We will discuss examples from the financial sector, health care sector, and architecture and urban planning from different theoretical stances (strategy, discourse, and practice theory).
The purpose of the panel is to open up the discussion on new work practices connected to the introduction of AI as a preamble to a more massive introduction of AI in social contexts. The panel wants to be generative in the sense that it will open up for questions and crate inspiration for further studies.

MAKING DECISIONS ABOUT DIGITAL FROM TOP MANAGEMENT AND DOWN

Nils Fonstad, Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT CISR), USA

Increasingly, digital technologies are taking the front stage in both the operations and the business models of organizations. Managers at all levels are asked to make decisions about technology. There is a myriad of cloud opportunities that make it possible for managers to make easy and fast decisions about technology that go beyond the traditional channel of interacting with the IT function in the organization. However, easy and fast does not also mean correct and organizations suffer from lack of well-defined governance about digital solutions. This talk will take a top management perspective on decision making about digital solutions. Will explore the opportunities that can guide decision making and the portfolio mix that managers should strive for in order to create organizations that will thrive in the coming future.

EVALUATING AI TOOLS FOR PROFESSIONAL WORK: FACING THE LIMITS OF PROFESSIONAL KNOWLEDGE

Natalia Levina, New York University Stern School of Business (NYU Stern), USA

Increasingly, AI tools are proclaimed to deliver performance levels that outperform human experts in wide varieties of decision-making scenarios. Tasked with assessing the value of AI tools in their work context, organization leaders face the need to examine performance claims reported by AI tool creators. We conducted a qualitative field study at a major US hospital, closely following managers' evaluation of five different AI tools for potential use by experts across four sections of radiology. We unpack how managers were peeling back the layers of AI tools' performance claims, tracing how the subject of evaluation shifted from the AI tools to the experts, and how that shaped the AI evaluation process. Deeper examining of AI tools' performance led managers to begin questioning AI tools' "ground truth" measures and eventually turned their questioning inward, as they were confronting the underlying black-box of the limits of their own performance. Our study illuminates the critical differences between "ground truth", professional standards, and practically-acceptable performance, and the implications of treating "ground truth" constructions as taken-for-granted when the underlying performance is highly uncertain. This study has implications for research and practice on evaluating AI technology in professional fields and comparing experts' and AI tools' performance.

URBAN VISION AFTER THE COMPUTATIONAL TURN: AN EXPERIMENT IN USING DIGITAL TRACES TO MAP PUBLIC LIFE

Anders Koed Madsen, Aalborg University, Denmark

One year ago researchers from TANTLab and employees from GEHL architects decided on pursuing an experiment together. Driven by a shared interest in bringing social issues into the technical paradigm of 'the smart city' we set ourselves the task of making the diversity of Copenhagen's social infrastructure legible through digital traces from Facebook. One result of the experiment was this interactive website: https://master--cph-bubbles.netlify.app/ (still in progress). Based on interviews and video-footage from the experimental process, this paper critically discusses how the experiment intervenes in the existing 'professional vision' (Goodwin, 1994) of the architects. This will be exemplified by diving into two tensions that emerged between the existing professional vision of the architects and the affordances of digital methods during the experimentation. The first concerns the commitment of architects to a physical conceptualization of space whereas the other concerns the professional commitment to demographic categorizations of social groups. Since digital traces are vague on both parameters, the concrete data experiments forced reflection on the

importance of these commitments and the extent to which it is desirable that new modes of datafying the city bring with them new urban ontologies.

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PANEL 18: DRONES AND THE DIGITIZATION OF SOCIAL PRACTICES

Panel organizer: Dylan Cawthorne, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

This panel aims to present a multidisciplinary view of drones and the digitization of social practices that they facilitate. It includes technologists developing drones that digitize nature to protect endangered species and those developing drone-mounted scanning methods to digitally preserve historic sites. It includes interdisciplinary research that takes ethics and human values explicitly into account when developing drones that support the digitization of work, impact privacy, and that can act as a technological mediation between operator and the environment. And this panel includes humanities research that debates the shifting role of humans and communities in the digital/drone age. Together, these presentations and the ensuing discussion seek to present drone technology in a nuanced way, and bring to the surface some of the most important impacts these techno/ethical/social changes could have on the future digitization of social practices.

Timeframe for panel, including all presentations: 90 minutes Estimated time pr. presentation: 15-20 minutes + Q&A's.

DRONES FOR WILDLIFE CONSERVATION AND THE DIGITIZATION OF NATURE

Ulrik Pagh Schults, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark,

The Earth is experiencing an exceptionally rapid loss of biodiversity, and more species are threatened with extinction now than at any previous point in human history (Ceballos, 2017). To halt this catastrophic trend, precise information on human impact on natural populations is required. Data from traditional censuses is often imprecise (Hodgson, 2018), but drones have proven highly effective for observation tasks in nature conservation scenarios (Hodgson, 2016). Our ongoing research concerns the automation of drone-based technology to automatically digitize nature, thus providing high-precision, low-cost digital models of wildlife across Europe and Africa.This concerns both overall wildlife population statistics, the behavior of selected species, and the health status of individual animals.

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DRONES FOR THE DIGITIZATION OF IMPORTANT SITES AND THE DIGITIZATION OF HISTORY DRONES IN HERITAGE DOCUMENTATION

Elzbieta Pastucha, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

Photogrammetry and Remote Sensing encompasses measurement (survey) techniques done without direct contact with the object of interest. Its results are all around us, from Google maps to computer games. With the emergence of drones and dedicated software, this technology became widely accessible. By now its implications can be found in any sector of the industry - agriculture, energy, crisis management, as well as heritage documentation and discovery. Documentation of heritage sites has multiple purposes. It can be used purely commercial by enabling regular people to view an object up close from the perspective of their couch or use as models in computer games (Statham, 2020). It has research implications. Archeologists employ drones to monitor the progress of the excavation (Rinaudo, et al. 2012) or find new structures (Harmon, et al.,2006)(Fernández-Lozano, et al.,2015). Photogrammetry derived models are used in simulations of natural disasters to prevent their impact on important sites or find the extend of the damage (Sarro, et al.,2018). New sensors are employed to find non-visible damage to the structures (Kaimaris & Aristoteles, 2020). However, perhaps the most important implication is the restoration process. A profound example is Notre Dame Cathedral that suffered a tragic fire in April of 2019. Detailed documentation of the interior as well as roof structure will be used in the restoration process (Praticò, et al., 2020).

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VALUE SENSITIVE DRONE DESIGN AND THE DIGITIZATION OF SOCIAL PRACTICES

Dylan Cawthorne, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

Drones facilitate social changes including the digitization of work (Oxford Research). They digitize the environment which has impacts on privacy (Luppicini, & So, 2016). And they act as a digital-technological mediation between the drone operator and the environment being observed (Verbeek, 2006). Value sensitive design (VSD) is a method of interdisciplinary research that takes ethics and human values explicitly into account when developing technologies (Friedman & Hendry, 2019) making it a useful approach in considering the impacts of digitization on drone design (Cawthorne & Cenci, 2019)(Cawthorne & Wynsberghe, 2019). A VSD analysis can lead to unique technologies, such as drones designed to create meaningful human work rather than simply replacing human labor with automation. The VSD perspective can lead engineers to develop privacy-preserving camera systems that cannot capture personal data, such as biometric data available from a normal video stream or to implement "g eo-fencing" where drones can only fly in authorized spacesand not over private homes or airports. And a VSD perspective may inspire designers to develop human-human interaction instead of human-drone interaction through speakers that allow the operator to communicate directly with the observer, and a microphone allowing the observer to respond. These and other examples of hopefully more preferable technological embodiments will be presented, as well as the limitations and challenges of the approach moving forward.

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HUMANS AS DRONES: DIGITALIZING COMMUNITIES

Kathrin Maurer, University of Southern Denmark, Denmark

Commercial drones are a popular prospect for industry and companies aiming for more efficiency, better infrastructure, and reduction of transportation costs. In contrast to their military relatives, these commercial drones often have the reputation of being good, humanitarian, and sustainable for the human community. Whereas there are certainly many examples where drone technology can be beneficial, this paper aims to discuss the impact of remote-controlled technology on human socialinteraction and communities. What is the relation between the producer (owner) and the user of drones? How do drones shape the perception of the human worker? Are drones just another technofix for current social-economic problems? In order to find answers to these questions, this paper turns to aesthetics, namely the field of drone art and investigates artistic representations and interpretations of drone technology. Thereby the paper discusses the case of the so-called Human Uber, a digital device attached to humans for rent, a film about the cyber-workforce of migrants (The Sleep Dealers, 2008), and passages from William Gibson's sci-fi novel Peripheral (2015) in which drone-like android bodies are controlled by pilots. In summary, from the perspective of a humanities' scholar, this paper aims to debate the changing status of human labor and communities in the context of (post) human digital technology.

References

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